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(54) **MUSIC ON A TWO-WAY SMART RADIO DEVICE**

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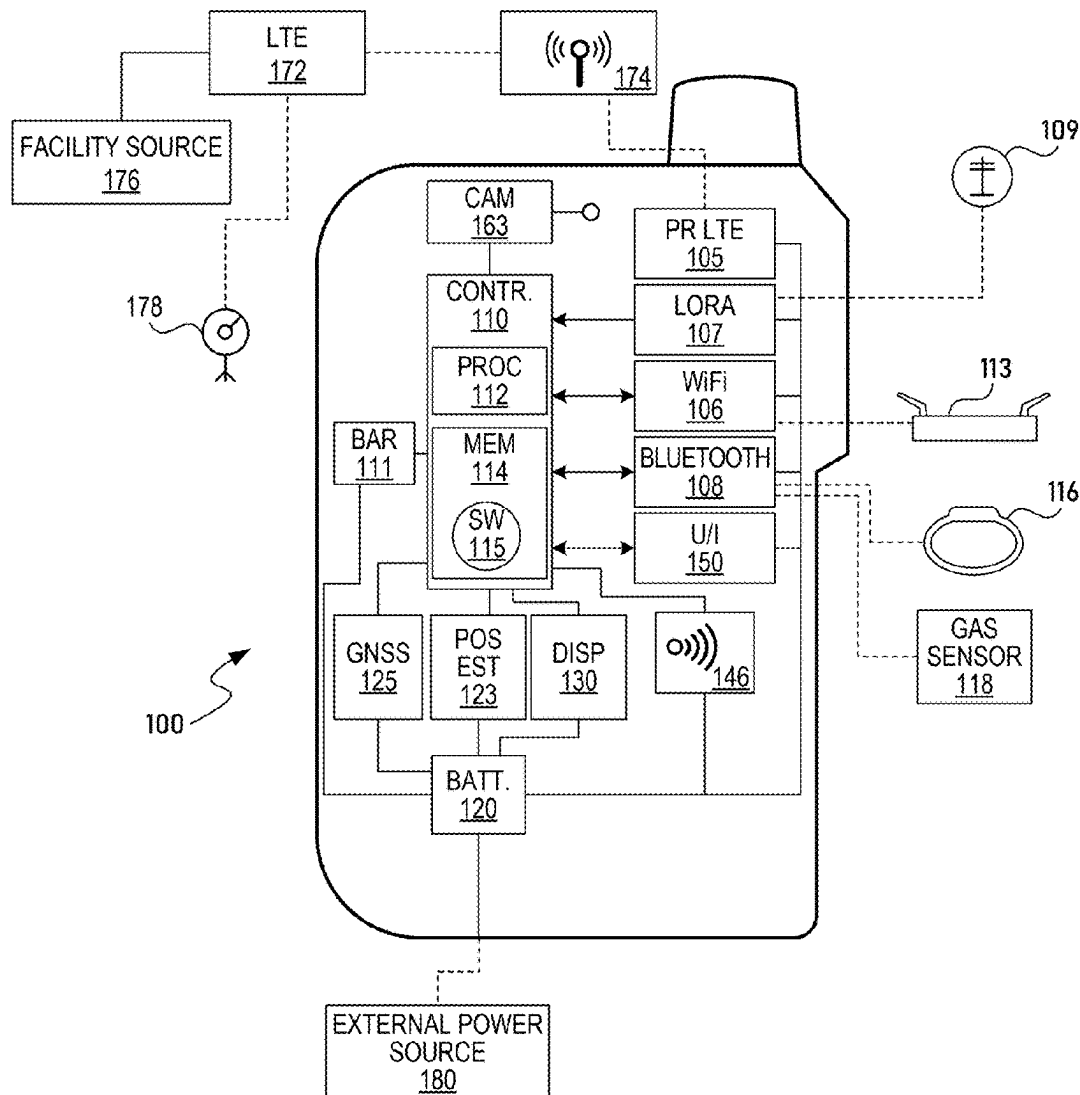
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A platform enables a user of a smart radio device to select a music channel for playback through a loudspeaker coupled to the smart radio device. The smart radio is configured for two-way communication and belongs to a group of smart radio devices associated with a facility. The platform sets parameter(s) for playback of music at the smart radio device in accordance with rule(s) that are implemented for the facility and cause the smart radio device to respond to an event detected at the smart radio device by performing an action. The event is based on a location of the smart radio device relative to a geofenced area of the facility or presence of a device, equipment, or machine in a threshold vicinity of the smart radio device. The action can include modifying value(s) of the parameter(s) of playback of music.



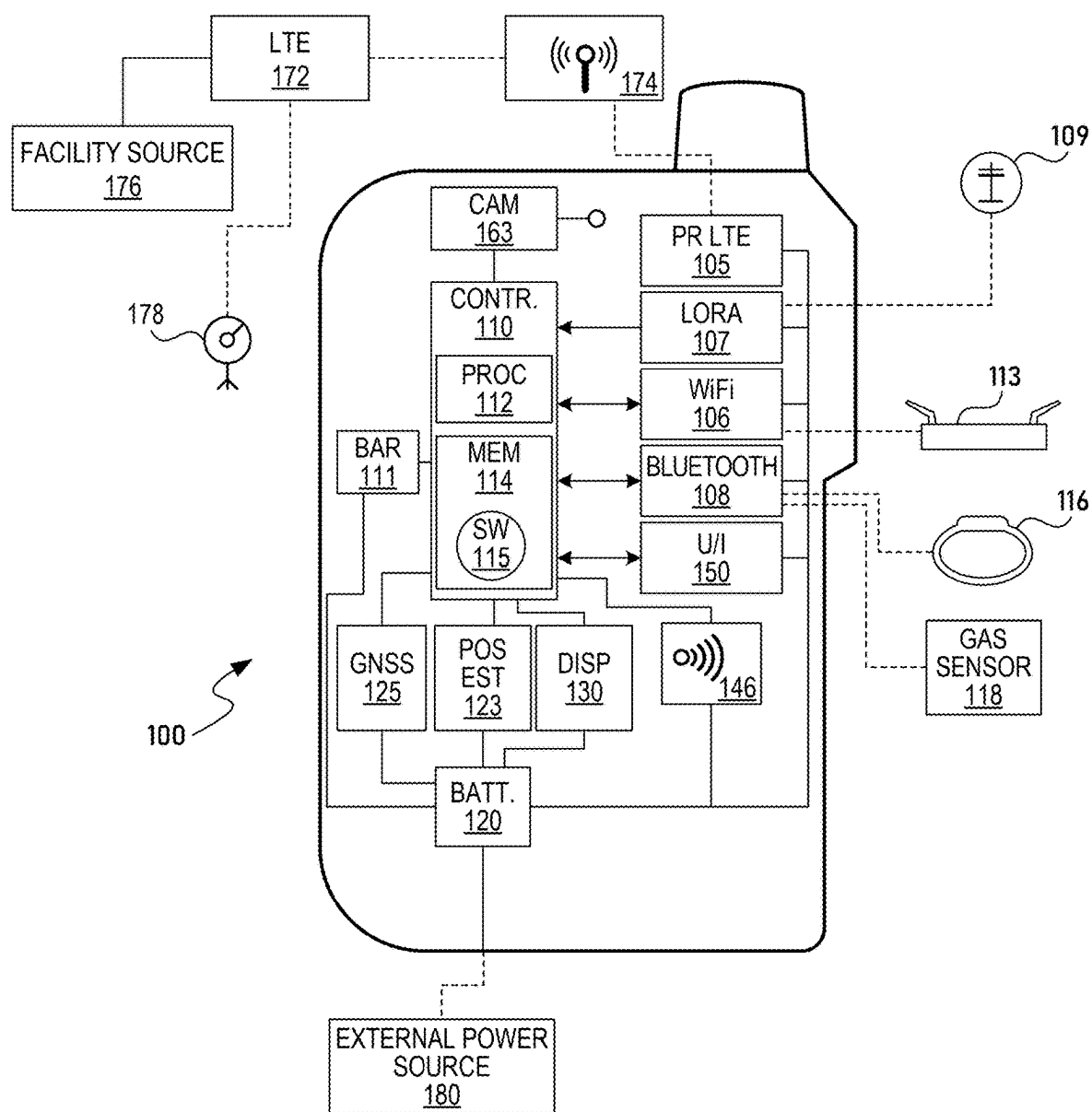


FIG. 1

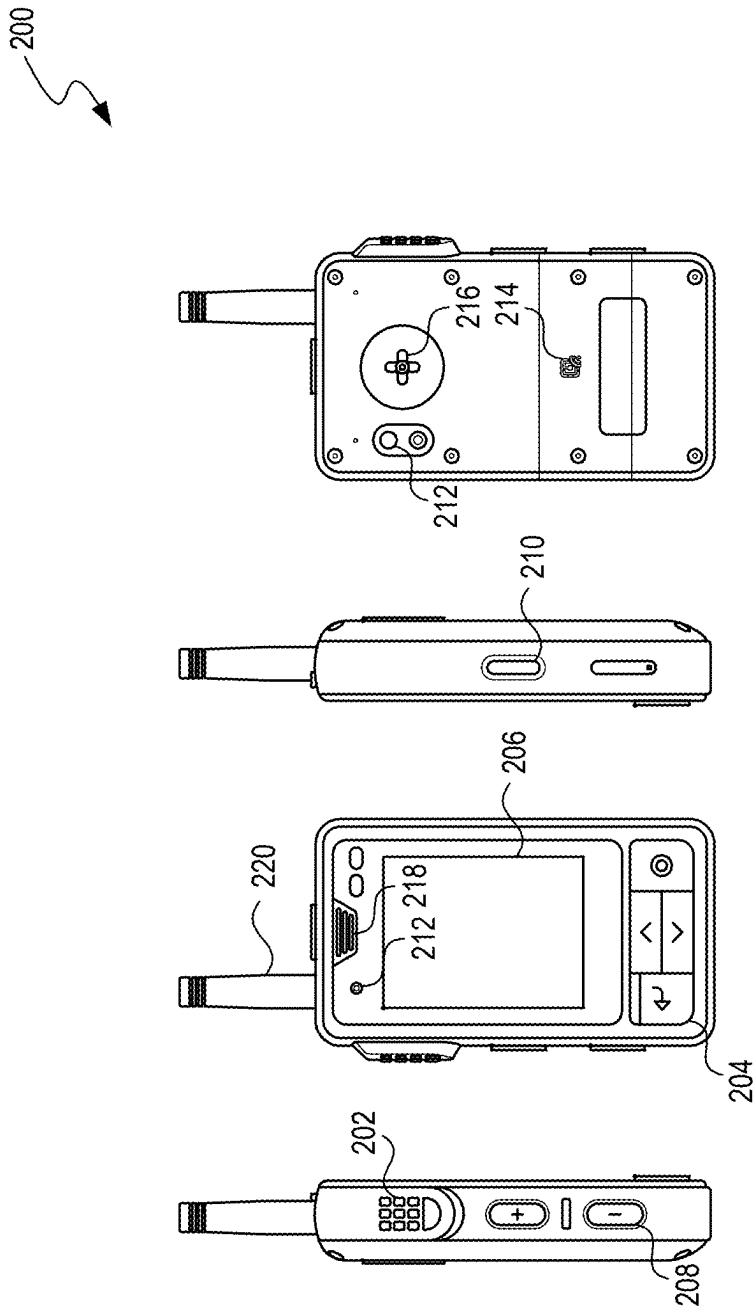


FIG. 2

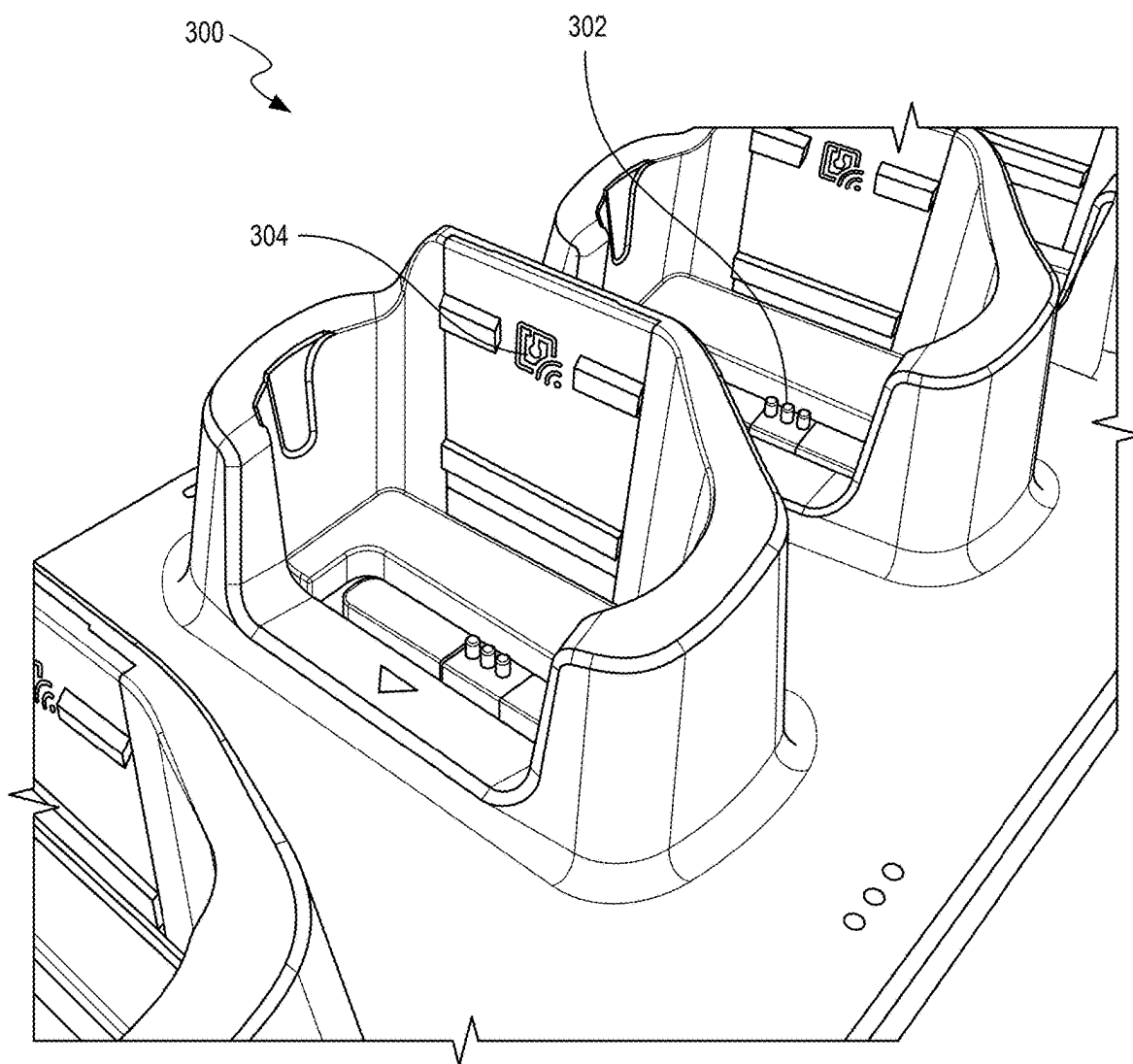


FIG. 3

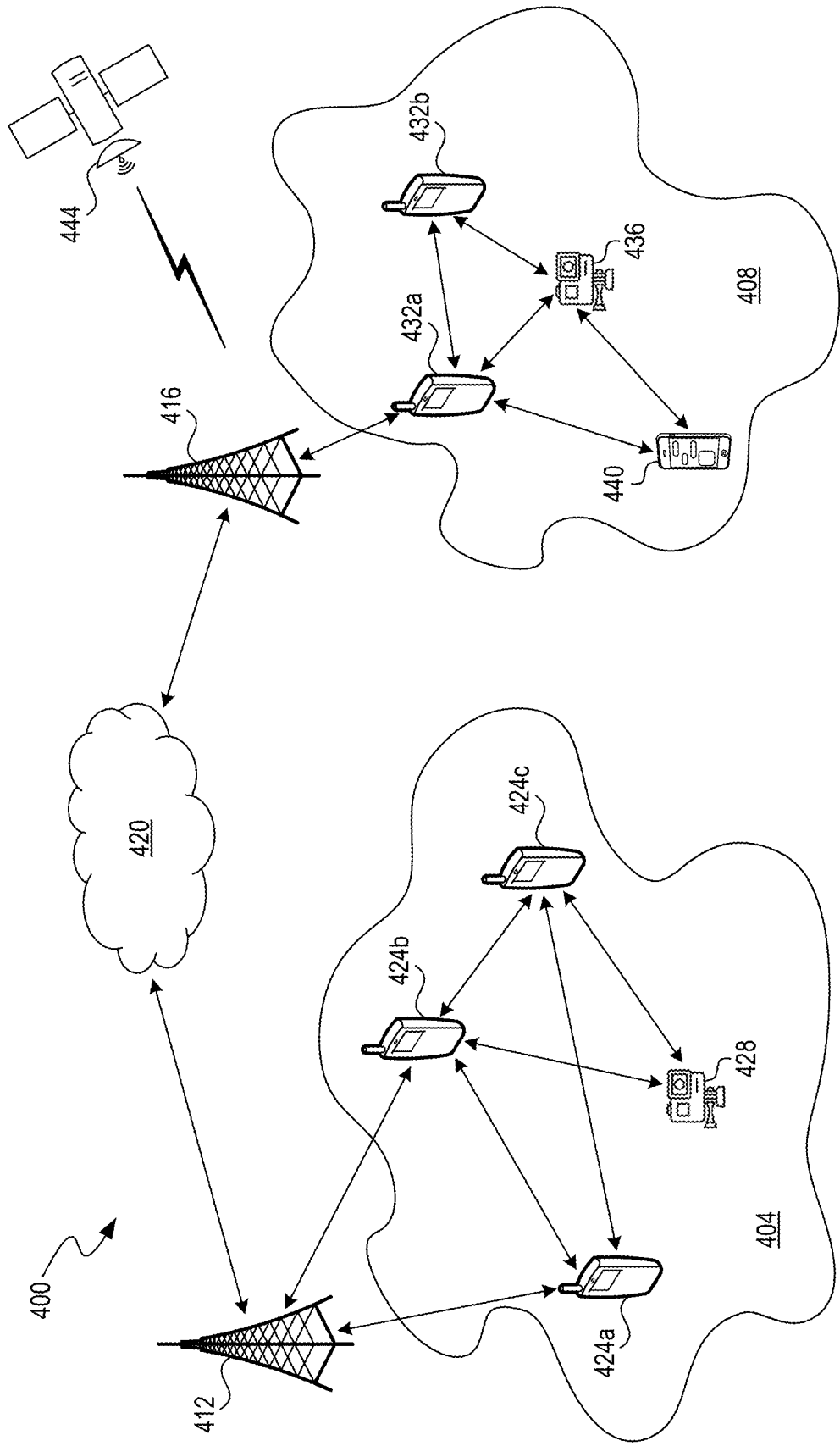


FIG. 4A

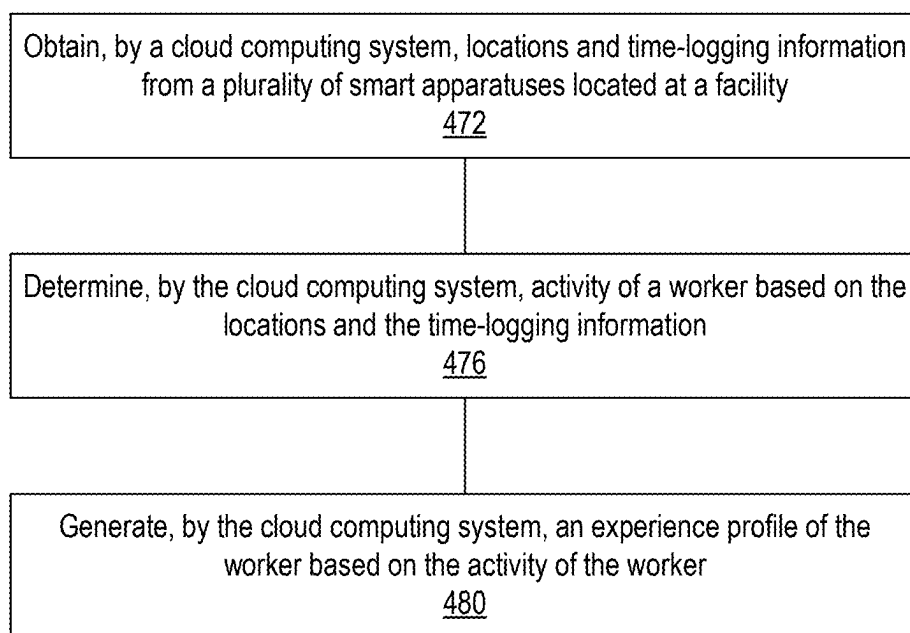


FIG. 4B

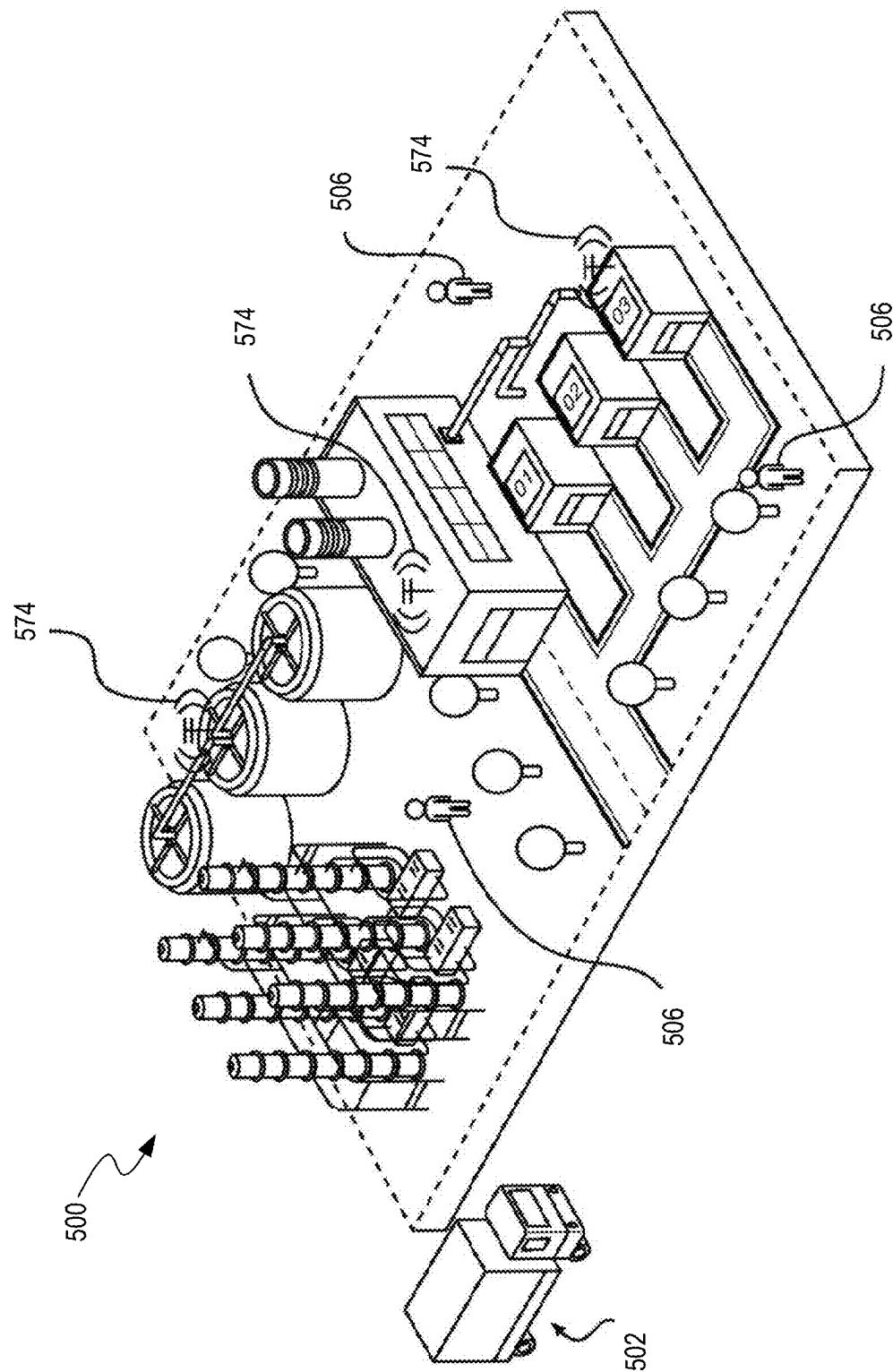


FIG. 5

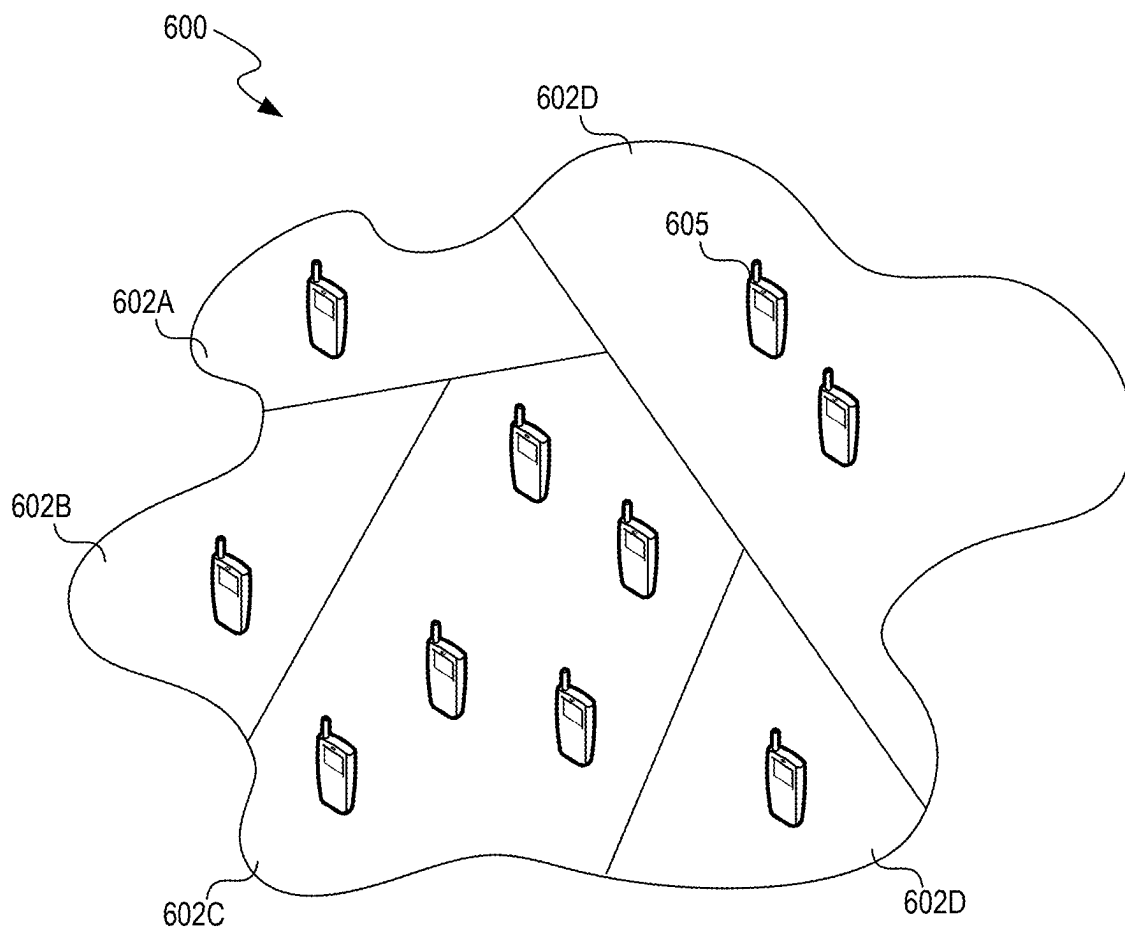


FIG. 6

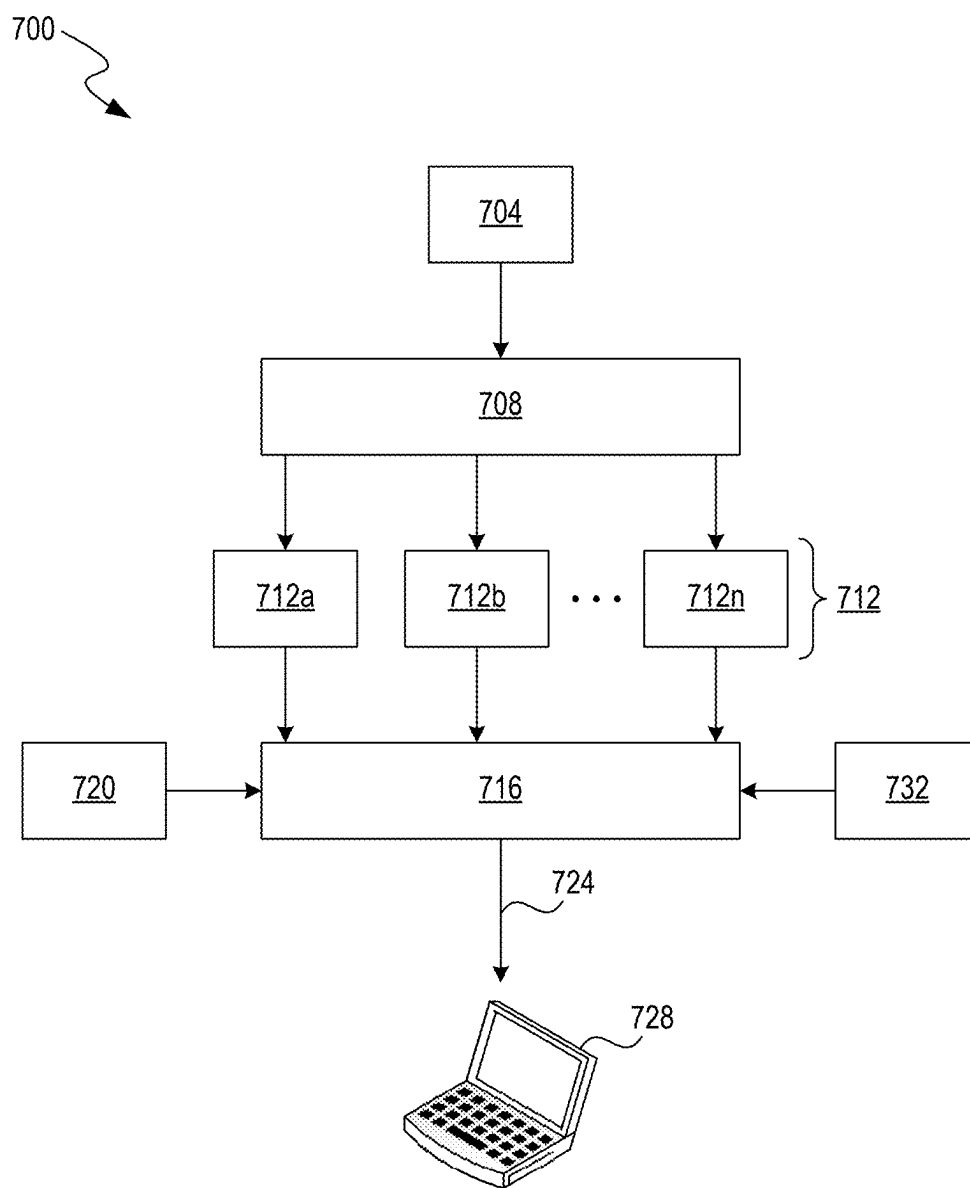


FIG. 7

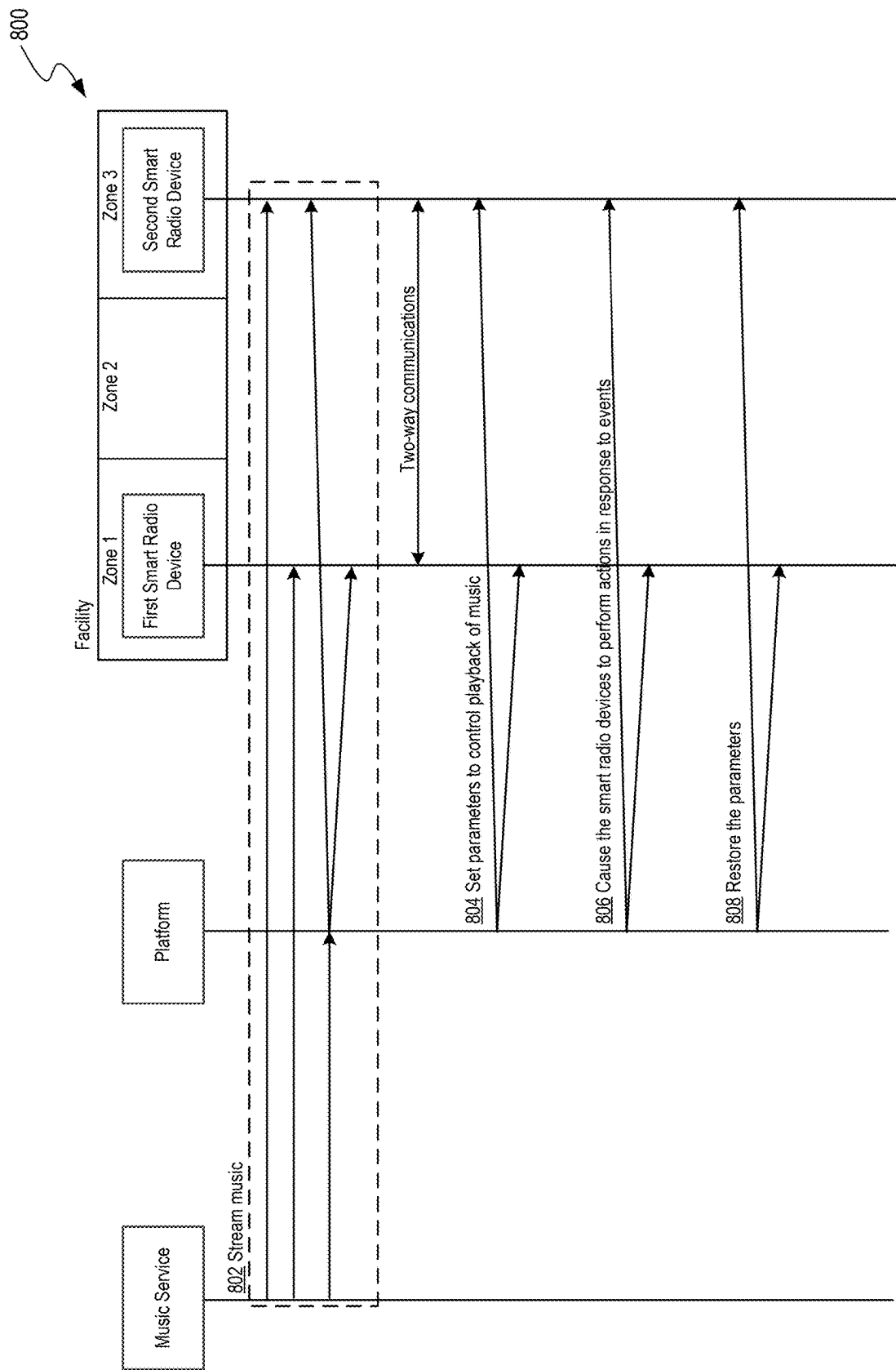


FIG. 8

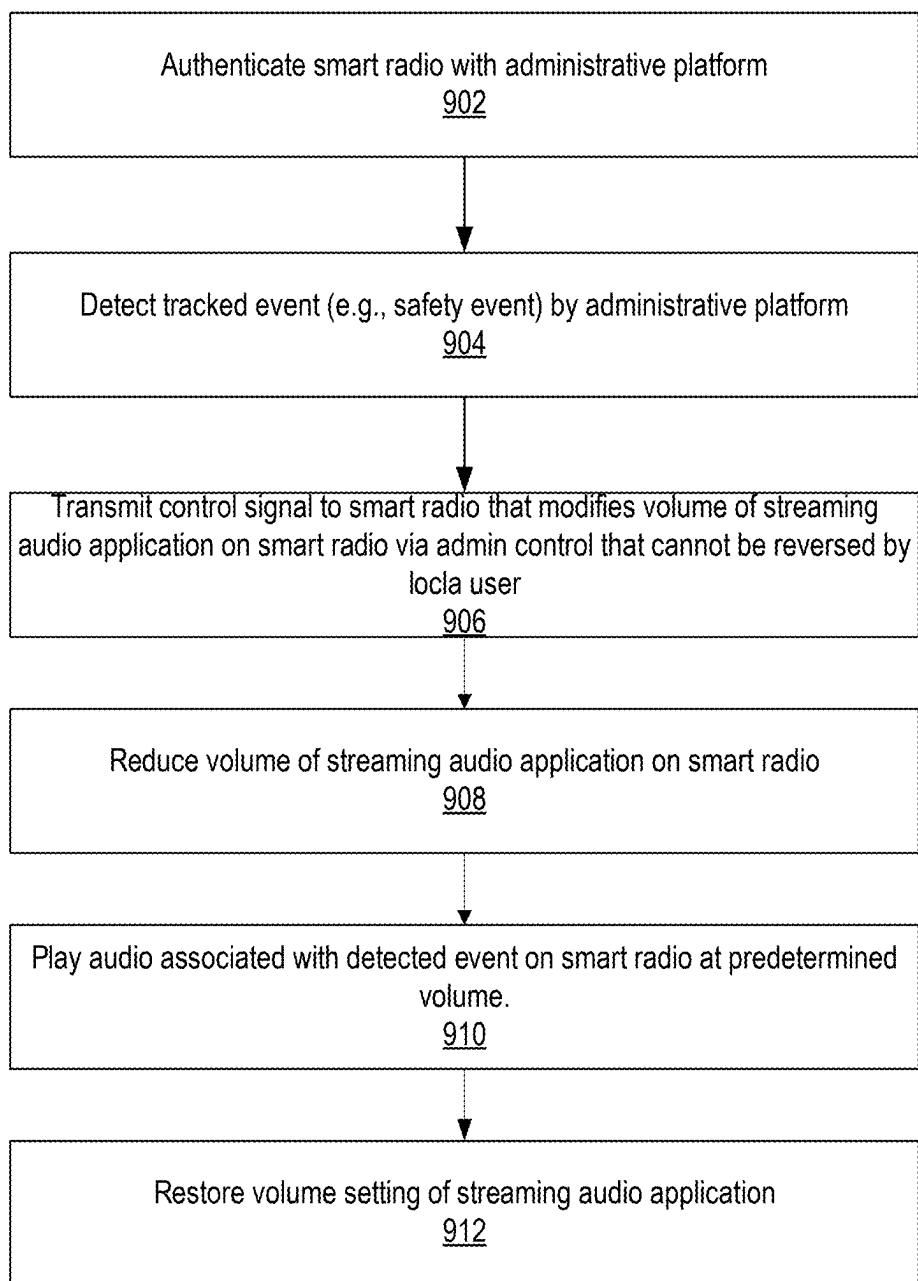


FIG. 9

First Inventor: Kevin Turpin
Title: Music on a two-way smart radio device

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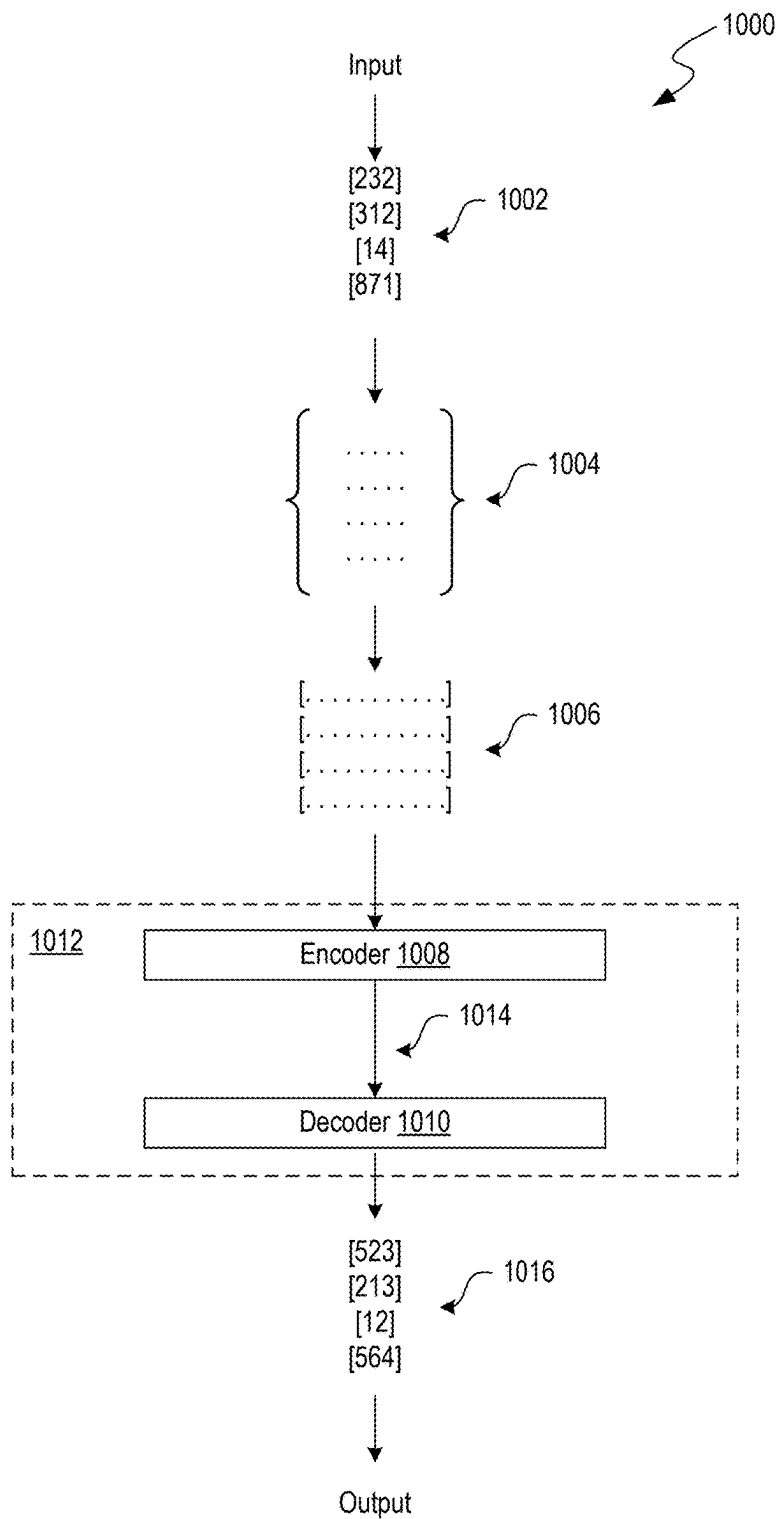


FIG. 10

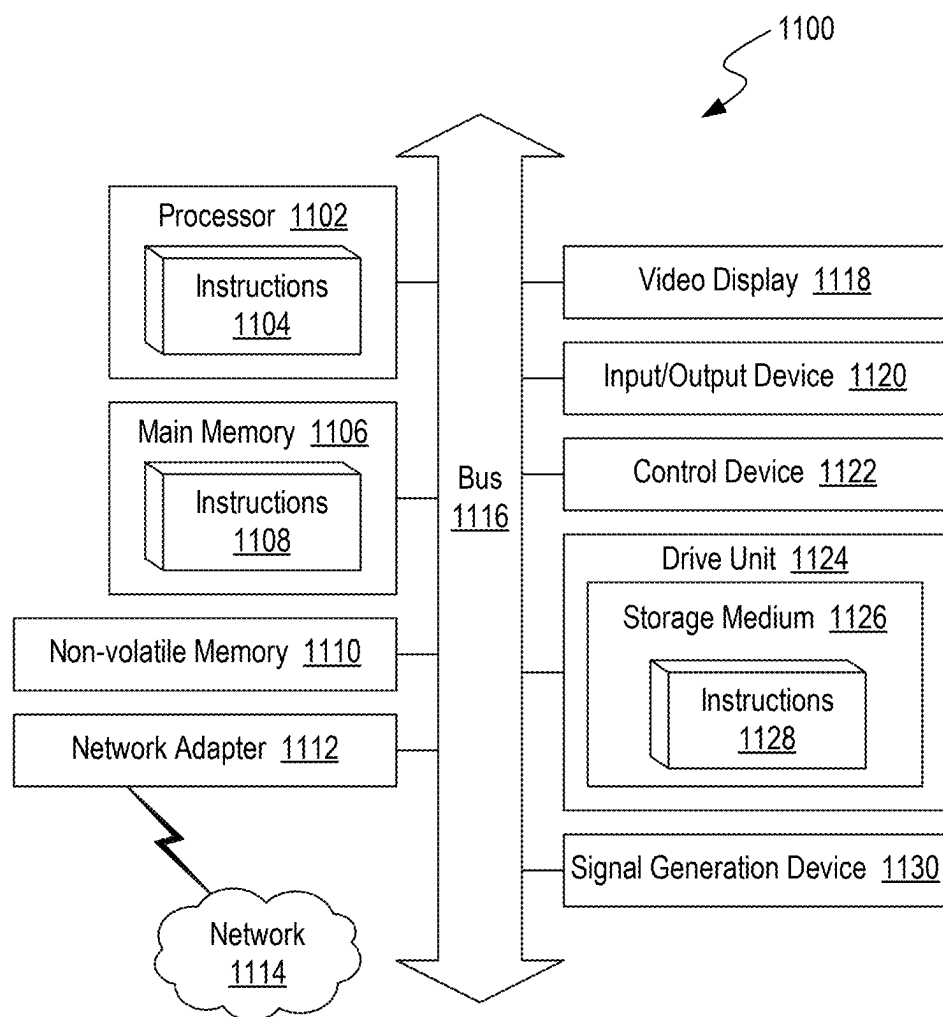


FIG. 11

MUSIC ON A TWO-WAY SMART RADIO DEVICE

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/562,871, filed Mar. 8, 2024, which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure is generally related to wireless communication handsets and systems that playback audio such as music.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Frontline workers often rely on radios to enable them to communicate with their team members. Traditional radios may fail to provide some communication services, requiring workers to carry additional devices to stay adequately connected to their team. Additionally frontline works are frequently limited in the radio equipment they may use for safety reasons. Due to safety restrictions, frontline workers are typically prevented from listening to music at least because of the noise pollution from music that contributes to a lack of awareness and safety hazards. When a user cannot hear their surroundings or potential emergency broadcasts because the music drowns out those sounds there is a safety concern. Accordingly, workers may be less accessible to their teams, which can lead to safety concerns and a decrease in productivity.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0004] FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example architecture for an apparatus for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0005] FIG. 2 is a drawing illustrating an example apparatus for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0006] FIG. 3 is a drawing illustrating an example charging station for apparatuses implementing device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0007] FIG. 4A is a drawing illustrating an example environment for apparatuses and communication networks for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0008] FIG. 4B is a flow diagram illustrating an example process for generating a work experience profile, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0009] FIG. 5 is a drawing illustrating an example facility using apparatuses and communication networks for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0010] FIG. 6 illustrates an example of a worksite that includes a plurality of geofenced areas, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating an example machine learning (ML) system, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0012] FIG. 8 is a diagram that illustrates a process for controlling playback of music at smart radio devices, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 9 is a diagram that illustrates a process for controlling volume of music at smart radio devices remotely.

[0014] FIG. 10 is a block diagram of a transformer neural network, which may be used in examples of the present disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating an example computer system, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0016] The technology relates to controlling music that is played on a two-way smart radio device to promote engagement among frontline workers (“workers”) who are users of the smart radio devices and provide safety mechanisms to ensure that the works maintain situational awareness so that they can perform their jobs safely. Moreover, the technology enables using the engagement of workers with a music service to deliver safety and training information, or other information that improves the situational awareness of the workers.

[0017] In one implementation, an audio service can act as a source of music (e.g., radio, playlist) to playback devices that are hosted by a platform that manages workers. An example of the playback devices includes fungible smart radio devices, smartphones, and tablets. The platform controls playback of the music on the playback devices based on, for example, whether the smart radio devices are associated with workers of a particular facility, the locations of the smart radio devices in the particular facility, and information about the particular worker using the smart radio device. The platform disclosed herein enables improvement of work environments by safely playing music for workers in a controlled manner.

[0018] In one example, the platform implements different rulesets for different facilities, different zones, and/or different users. The degree of control that is remotely exercised over the smart radio devices enables volume limits and input regulation on a remote administrative basis. When security or safety messages are being broadcast, remote administrative controls enable shifting inputs on the smart radios away from music and solely to the safety messages. Further, said remote administrative controls enable providing for a situationally variable maximum volume. Examples of implementation of the remote administrative controls include application-level control, operating system-level control, or root device access level controls.

[0019] Example safety features include threshold volume limits or automatic attenuation or muting of the music depending on the location of the smart radio, location of surrounding tracked objects, or whether an emergency event occurred near a location. Further, the platform is enabled to control an electronic DJ that integrates Artificial Intelligence (AI) generated messages that are rendered as audio that plays over or instead of the music being rendered by selected smart radio devices or across groups of devices. For example, an AI system monitors the state, behavior, or location of users to trigger generation of different messages that are played to warn the users of risks or harms. In one example, the smart radio devices are assigned for a location such that a geofences are used to control audio based on a zone, a role of the worker, and/or a type of task being performed by the worker using the smart radio device. The messages that are rendered on particular smart radio devices can be played in native languages of their users. That is, the

same message can be converted into different languages and routed to different smart radio devices for different users.

[0020] The smart radio devices are used to communicate between various workers. As the responsibilities of these workers adapt with technology, however, the functionality of mobile radio devices must evolve to provide additional functionality. For example, mobile radio devices have been improved to increase connectivity in previously disconnected locations. Moreover, improvements in mobile radio devices enable workers to communicate through additional forms of communication, often without user intervention. Mobile radio devices also provide a mechanism for tracking workers and equipment on a worksite to improve safety and efficiency. Mobile radio devices can further track details about employees during their work shift, and that information can be used to analyze the employees' strengths and weaknesses. Accordingly, the present disclosure relates to improvements in mobile radio devices. In general, improvements are directed to one of four technical aspects ("pillars"): network connectivity, collaboration, location services, and data, which are explained below.

[0021] Network connectivity: Smart radios operate using multiple onboard radios and connect to a set of known networks. This pillar refers to radio selection (e.g., use of multiple onboard radios in various contexts) and network selection (e.g., selecting which network to connect to from available networks in various contexts). These decisions may depend on data obtained from other pillars; however, inventions directed to the connectivity pillar have outputs that relate to improvements to network or radio communications/selections.

[0022] Collaboration: This pillar relates to communication between users. A collaboration platform includes chat channel selection, audio transcription and interpretation, sentiment analysis, and workflow improvements. The associated smart radio devices further include interface features that improve ease of communication through reduction in button presses and hands-free information delivery. Inventions in this pillar relate to improvements or gained efficiencies in communicating between users and/or the platform itself.

[0023] Location services: This pillar refers to various means of identifying the location of devices and people. There are straightforward or primary means, such as the Global Positioning System (GPS), accelerometer, or cellular triangulation. However, there are also secondary means by which known locations (via primary means) are used to derive the location of other unknown devices. For example, a set of smart radio devices with known locations are used to triangulate other devices or equipment. Further location services inventions relate to identification of the behavior of human users of the devices, e.g., micromotions of the device indicate that it is being worn, whereas lack of motion indicates that the device has been placed on a surface. Inventions in this pillar relate to the identification of the physical location of objects or workers.

[0024] Data: This pillar relates to the "Internet of Workers" platform. Each of the other pillars leads to the collection of data. Implementation of that data into models provides valuable insights that illustrate a given worksite to users who are not physically present at that worksite. Such insights include productivity of workers, experience of workers, and accident or hazard mapping. Inventions in the data pillar

relate to deriving insight or conclusions from one or more sources of data collected from any available sensor in the worksite.

[0025] Embodiments of the present disclosure will now be described with reference to the following figures. Although illustrated and described with respect to specific examples, embodiments of the present disclosure can be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein. Accordingly, the examples set forth herein are non-limiting examples referenced to improve the description of the present technology.

Portable Wireless Apparatus

[0026] FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example architecture for an apparatus 100 for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments. The wireless apparatus 100 is implemented using components of the example computer system illustrated and described in more detail with reference to subsequent figures. In embodiments, the apparatus 100 is used to execute the ML system illustrated and described in more detail with reference to subsequent figures. The architecture shown by FIG. 1 is incorporated into a portable wireless apparatus 100, such as a smart radio, a smart camera, a smart watch, a smart headset, or a smart sensor. Although illustrated in a particular configuration, different embodiments of the apparatus 100 include different and/or additional components connected in different ways.

[0027] The apparatus 100 includes a controller 110 communicatively coupled either directly or indirectly to a variety of wireless communication arrangements. The apparatus 100 includes a position estimating component 123 (e.g., a dead-reckoning system), which estimates current position using inertia, speed, and intermittent known positions received from a position tracking component 125, which, in embodiments, is a Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) component. A battery 120 is electrically coupled with a cellular subsystem 105 (e.g., a private Long-Term Evolution (LTE) wireless communication subsystem), a Wi-Fi subsystem 106, a low-power wide area network (LPWAN) (e.g., LPWAN/long-range (LoRa) network subsystem 107), a Bluetooth subsystem 108, a barometer 111, an audio device 146, a user interface 150, and a built-in camera 163 for providing electrical power.

[0028] The battery 120 can be electrically and communicatively coupled with the controller 110 for providing electrical power to the controller 110 and to enable the controller 110 to determine a status of the battery 120 (e.g., a state of charge). In embodiments, the battery 120 is a non-removable rechargeable battery (e.g., using external power source 180). In this way, the battery 120 cannot be removed by a worker to power down the apparatus 100, or subsystems of the apparatus 100 (e.g., the position tracking component 125), thereby ensuring connectivity to the workforce throughout their shift. Moreover, the apparatus 100 cannot be disconnected from the network by removing the battery 120, thereby reducing the likelihood of device theft. In some cases, the apparatus 100 can include an additional, removable battery to enable the apparatus 100 to be used for prolonged periods without requiring additional charging time.

[0029] The controller 110 is, for example, a computer having a memory 114, including a non-transitory storage medium for storing software 115, and a processor 112 for

executing instructions of the software **115**. In some embodiments, the controller **110** is a microcontroller, a microprocessor, an integrated circuit (IC), or a system-on-a-chip (SoC). The controller **110** can include at least one clock capable of providing time stamps or displaying time via display **130**. The at least one clock can be updatable (e.g., via the user interface **150**, the position tracking component **125**, the Wi-Fi subsystem **106**, the private cellular network **107** subsystem, a server, or a combination thereof).

[0030] The wireless communications arrangement can include a cellular subsystem **105**, a Wi-Fi subsystem **106**, a LPWAN/LoRa network subsystem **107** wirelessly connected to a LPWAN network **109**, or a Bluetooth subsystem **108** enabling sending and receiving. Cellular subsystem **105**, in embodiments, enables the apparatus **100** to communicate with at least one wireless antenna **174** located at a facility (e.g., a manufacturing facility, a refinery, or a construction site), examples of which may be illustrated in and described with respect to the subsequent figures.

[0031] In embodiments, a cellular edge router arrangement **172** is provided for implementing a common wireless source. The cellular edge router arrangement **172** (sometimes referred to as an “edge kit”) can provide a wireless connection to the Internet. In embodiments, the LPWAN network **109**, the wireless cellular network, or a local radio network is implemented as a local network for the facility usable by instances of the apparatus **100**. For example, the cellular type can be 2G, 3G, 4G, LTE, 5G, etc. The edge kit **172** is typically located near a facility’s primary Internet source **176** (e.g., a fiber backhaul or other similar device). Alternatively, a local network of the facility is configured to connect to the Internet using signals from a satellite source, transceiver, or router **178**, especially in a remotely located facility not having a backhaul source, or where a mobile arrangement not requiring a wired connection is desired. More specifically, the satellite source plus edge kit **172** is, in embodiments, configured into a vehicle, or portable system. In embodiments, the cellular subsystem **105** is incorporated into a local or distributed cellular network operating on any of the existing **88** different Evolved Universal Mobile Telecommunications System Terrestrial Radio Access (EUTRA) operating bands (ranging from 700 MHz up to 2.7 GHz). For example, the apparatus **100** can operate using a duplex mode implemented using time division duplexing (TDD) or frequency division duplexing (FDD).

[0032] The Wi-Fi subsystem **106** enables the apparatus **100** to communicate with an access point **113** capable of transmitting and receiving data wirelessly in a relatively high-frequency band. In embodiments, the Wi-Fi subsystem **106** is also used in testing the apparatus **100** prior to deployment. The Bluetooth subsystem **108** enables the apparatus **100** to communicate with a variety of peripheral devices, including a biometric interface device **116** and a gas/chemical detection sensor **118** used to detect noxious gases. In embodiments, numerous other Bluetooth devices are incorporated into the apparatus **100**.

[0033] As used herein, the wireless subsystems of the apparatus **100** include any wireless technologies used by the apparatus **100** to communicate wirelessly (e.g., via radio waves) with other apparatuses in a facility (e.g., multiple sensors, a remote interface, etc.), and optionally with the Internet (“the cloud”) for accessing websites, databases, etc. For example, the apparatus **100** can be capable of connecting with a conference call or video conference at a remote

conferencing server. The apparatus **100** can interface with a conferencing software (e.g., Microsoft Teams™, Skype™, Zoom™, Cisco Webex™). The wireless subsystems **105**, **106**, and **108** are each configured to transmit/receive data in an appropriate format, for example, in IEEE 802.11, 802.15, 802.16 Wi-Fi standards, Bluetooth standard, WinnForum Spectrum Access System (SAS) test specification (WINNF-TS-0065), and across a desired range. In embodiments, multiple mobile radio devices are connected to provide data connectivity and data sharing. In embodiments, the shared connectivity is used to establish a mesh network.

[0034] The position tracking component **125** and the position estimating component **123** operate in concert. The position tracking component **125** is used to track the location of the apparatus **100**. In embodiments, the position tracking component **125** is a GNSS (e.g., GPS, Quasi-Zenith Satellite System (QZSS), BEIDOU, GALILEO, GLONASS) navigational device that receives information from satellites and determines a geographic position based on the received information. The position determined from the GNSS navigation device can be augmented with location estimates based on waves received from proximate devices. For example, the position tracking component **125** can determine a location of the apparatus **100** relative to one or more proximate devices using receives signal strength indicator (RSSI) techniques, time difference of arrival (TDOA) techniques, or any other appropriate techniques. The relative position can then be combined with the position of the proximate devices to determine a location estimate of the apparatus **100**, which can be used to augment or replace other location estimates. In embodiments, a geographic position is determined at regular intervals (e.g., every five minutes, every minute, every five seconds), and the position in between readings is estimated using the position estimating component **123**.

[0035] Position data is stored in memory **114** and uploaded to server at regular intervals (e.g., every five minutes, every minute, every five seconds). In embodiments, the intervals for recording and uploading position data are configurable. For example, if the apparatus **100** is stationary for a predetermined duration, the intervals are ignored or extended, and new location information is not stored or uploaded. If no connectivity exists for wirelessly communicating with a server, location data can be stored in memory **114** until connectivity is restored, at which time the data is uploaded and then deleted from memory **114**. In embodiments, position data is used to determine latitude, longitude, altitude, speed, heading, and Greenwich mean time (GMT), for example, based on instructions of software **115** or based on external software (e.g., in connection with the server). In embodiments, position information is used to monitor worker efficiency, overtime, compliance, and safety, as well as to verify time records and adherence to company policies.

[0036] In some embodiments, a Bluetooth tracking arrangement using beacons is used for position tracking and estimation. For example, the Bluetooth subsystem **108** receives signals from Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) beacons located about the facility. The controller **110** is programmed to execute relational distancing software using beacon signals (e.g., triangulating between beacon distance information) to determine the position of the apparatus **100**. Regardless of the process, the Bluetooth subsystem **108** detects the beacon signals and the controller **110** determines the distances used in estimating the location of the apparatus **100**.

[0037] In alternative embodiments, the apparatus **100** uses Ultra-Wideband (UWB) technology with spaced-apart beacons for position tracking and estimation. The beacons are small, battery-powered sensors that are spaced apart in the facility and broadcast signals received by a UWB component included in the apparatus **100**. A worker's position is monitored throughout the facility over time when the worker is carrying or wearing the apparatus **100**. As described herein, location-sensing GNSS and estimating systems (e.g., the position tracking component **125** and the position estimating component **123**) can be used to primarily determine a horizontal location. In embodiments, the barometer **111** is used to determine a height at which the apparatus **100** is located (or operates in concert with the GNSS to determine the height) using known vertical barometric pressures at the facility. With the addition of a sensed height, a full three-dimensional location is determined by the processor **112**. Applications of the embodiments include determining if a worker is, for example, on stairs or a ladder, atop or elevated inside a vessel, or in other relevant locations.

[0038] In embodiments, the display **130** is a touch screen implemented using a liquid-crystal display (LCD), an e-ink display, an organic light-emitting diode (OLED), or other digital display capable of displaying text and images. In embodiments, the display **130** uses a low-power display technology, such as an e-ink display, for reduced power consumption. Images displayed using the display **130** include, but are not limited to, photographs, video, text, icons, symbols, flowcharts, instructions, cues, and warnings.

[0039] The audio device **146** optionally includes at least one microphone (not shown) and a speaker for receiving and transmitting audible sounds, respectively. Although only one audio device **146** is shown in the architecture drawing of FIG. **1**, it should be understood that in an actual physical embodiment, multiple speakers or microphones can be utilized to enable the apparatus **100** to adequately receive and transmit audio. In embodiments, the speaker has an output around 105 dB to be loud enough to be heard by a worker in a noisy facility. The microphone of the audio device **146** receives the spoken sounds and transmits signals representative of the sounds to the controller **110** for processing.

[0040] The apparatus **100** can be a shared device that is assigned to a particular user temporarily (e.g., for a shift). In embodiments, the apparatus **100** communicates with a worker ID badge using near field communication (NFC) technology. In this way, a worker may log in to a profile (e.g., stored at a remote server) on the apparatus **100** through their worker ID badge. The worker's profile may store information related to the worker. Examples include name, employee or contractor serial number, login credentials, emergency contact(s), address, shifts, roles (e.g., crane operator), calendars, or any other professional or personal information. Moreover, the user, when logged in, can be associated with the apparatus **100**. When another user logs in to the apparatus **100**, however, that user can then be associated with the apparatus **100**.

[0041] FIG. **2** is a drawing illustrating an example apparatus **200** for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments. The apparatus **200** includes a user interface that includes a PTT button **202**, a 4-button user input system **204**, a display **206**, an easy to grab volume control **208**, and a power button **210**. The PTT button **202** can be used to control the transmission of data from or the reception of data by the apparatus **200**. For

example, the apparatus **200** may transmit audio data or other data when the PTT button **202** is pressed and receive audio data or other data when the PTT button **202** is released. In other examples, the PTT button **202** may control the transmission of audio data or other data from the apparatus **200** (e.g., transmit when the PTT button **202** is pressed), though apparatus **200** may transmit and receive audio data or other data at the same time (e.g., full duplex communication). The 4-button user input system **204** can be used to interact with the apparatus **200**. For example, the 4-button user input system **204** can be used as a 4-direction input system (e.g., up-down-left-right), a 2-directional-enter-back (e.g., up-down-enter-back), or any other button configuration. The display **206** can output relevant visual information to the user. In aspects, the display **206** can enable touch input by the user to control the apparatus **200**. The volume control **208** can control the loudness of the apparatus **200**. The power button **210** can turn the apparatus **200** on and off.

[0042] The apparatus **200** further includes at least one camera **212**, an NFC tag **214**, a mount **216**, at least one speaker **218**, and at least one antenna **220**. The camera **212** can be implemented as a front camera capturing the environment in front of the display **206** or a back camera capturing the environment opposite the display **206**. The NFC tag **214** can be used to connect or register the apparatus **200**. For example, the NFC tag **214** can register the apparatus **200** as being docked in a charging station. In yet another example, the NFC tag can connect to a workers badge to associate the apparatus with the worker. The mount **216** can be used to attach the apparatus **200** to the worker (e.g., on a utility belt of the worker). The speaker **218** can output audio received by or presented on the apparatus **200**. The volume of the speaker **218** can be controlled by the volume control **208**. The antenna **220** can be used to transmit data from the apparatus **200** or receive data at the apparatus **200**. In some cases, transmission or reception by the antenna **220** can be controlled by the PTT button **202** or another button of the user interface.

Charging Station

[0043] FIG. **3** is a drawing illustrating an example charging station **300** for apparatuses implementing device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments. The charging station **300** can be used to dock one or more mobile radio devices for charging. In aspects, power can be supplied to the mobile radio devices docked at the charging station **300** through charging pins **302** located in each receptacle of the charging station **300**. The charging pins **302** can be inserted into a charging port of the mobile radio devices. A worker clocking out at a facility can place a mobile radio device into the charging station **300**. The mobile radio device can remain docked until it is removed from the charging station **300** by a worker clocking in at the facility.

[0044] The charging station **300** or the mobile radio device can determine when the mobile radio device has been docked in the charging station **300**. For example, each receptacle of the charging station **300** can have an NFC pad **304** that connects with the mobile radio device when the mobile radio device is docked in that receptacle of the charging station **300**. Alternatively or additionally, the mobile radio device can be determined to be docked in the charging station **300** when the charging pins **302** of a receptacle are inserted into the mobile radio device. In these

ways, a cloud computing system can be made aware of the location and status (e.g., docked or removed) of the mobile radio device through communication with the charging station 300 or the mobile radio device.

Communication Network

[0045] FIG. 4A is a drawing illustrating an example environment 400 for apparatuses and communication networks for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments. The environment 400 includes a cloud computing system 420, cellular transmission towers 412, 416, and local networks 404, 408. Components of the environment 400 are implemented using components of the example computer system illustrated and described in more detail with reference to subsequent figures. Likewise, different embodiments of the apparatus 100 include different and/or additional components and are connected in different ways.

[0046] Smart radios 424 (e.g., smart radios 424a-424c), smart radios 432 (e.g., smart radios 432a-b) and smart cameras 428, 436 are implemented in accordance with the architecture shown by FIG. 1. In embodiments, smart sensors implemented in accordance with the architecture shown by FIG. 1 are also connected to the local networks 404, 408 and mounted on a surface of a worksite, or worn or carried by workers. For example, the local network 404 is located at a first facility and the local network 408 is at a second facility. In embodiments, each smart radio and other smart apparatus has two Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) cards, sometimes referred to as dual SIM. A SIM card is an IC intended to securely store an international mobile subscriber identity (IMSI) number and its related key, which are used to identify and authenticate subscribers on mobile telephony devices.

[0047] A first SIM card enables the smart radio 424a to connect to the local (e.g., cellular) network 404 and a second SIM card enables the smart radio 424a to connect to a commercial cellular tower (e.g., cellular transmission tower 412) for access to mobile telephony, the Internet, and the cloud computing system 420 (e.g., to major participating networks such as Verizon™, AT&T™, T-Mobile™, or Sprint™). In such embodiments, the smart radio 424a has two radio transceivers, one for each SIM card. In other embodiments, the smart radio 424a has two active SIM cards, and the SIM cards both use only one radio transceiver. However, the two SIM cards are both active only as long as both are not in simultaneous use. As long as the SIM cards are both in standby mode, a voice call could be initiated on either one. However, once the call begins, the other SIM card becomes inactive until the first SIM card is no longer actively used.

[0048] In embodiments, the local network 404 uses a private address space of Internet protocol (IP) addresses. In other embodiments, the local network 404 is a local radio-based network using peer-to-peer (P2P) two-way radio (duplex communication) with extended range based on hops (e.g., from smart radio 424a to smart radio 424b to smart radio 424c). Hence, radio communication is transferred similarly to addressed packet-based data with packet switching by each smart radio or other smart apparatus on the path from source to destination. For example, each smart radio or other smart apparatus operates as a transmitter, receiver, or transceiver for the local network 404 to serve a facility. The smart apparatuses serve as multiple transmit/receive sites

interconnected to achieve the range of coverage required by the facility. Further, the signals on the local networks 404, 408 are backhauled to a central switch for communication to the cellular transmission towers 412, 416.

[0049] In embodiments (e.g., in more remote locations), the local network 404 is implemented by sending radio signals between multiple smart radios 424. Such embodiments are implemented in less-inhabited locations (e.g., wilderness) where workers are spread out over a larger work area that may be otherwise inaccessible to commercial cellular service. An example is where power company technicians are examining or otherwise working on power lines over larger distances that are often remote. The embodiments are implemented by transmitting radio signals from a smart radio 424a to other smart radios 424b, 424c on one or more frequency channels operating as a two-way radio. The radio messages sent include a header and a payload. Such broadcasting does not require a session or a connection between the devices. Data in the header is used by a receiving smart radio 424b to direct the “packet” to a destination (e.g., smart radio 424c). At the destination, the payload is extracted and played back by the smart radio 424c via the radio’s speaker.

[0050] For example, the smart radio 424a broadcasts voice data using radio signals. Any other smart radio 424b within a range limit (e.g., 1 mile, 2 miles, etc.) receives the radio signals. The radio data includes a header having the destination of the message (smart radio 424c). The radio message is decrypted/decoded and played back on only the destination smart radio 424c. If another smart radio 424b that was not the destination radio receives the radio signals, the smart radio 424b rebroadcasts the radio signals rather than decoding and playing them back on a speaker. The smart radios 424 are thus used as signal repeaters. The advantages and benefits of the embodiments disclosed herein include extending the range of two-way radios or smart radios 424 by implementing radio hopping between the radios.

[0051] In embodiments, the local network 404 is implemented using Citizens Broadband Radio Service (CBRS). The use of CBRS Band 48 (from 3550 MHz to 3700 MHz), in embodiments, provides numerous advantages. For example, the use of CBRS Band 48 provides longer signal ranges and smoother handovers. The use of CBRS Band 48 supports numerous smart radios 424 and smart cameras 428 at the same time. A smart apparatus is therefore sometimes referred to as a Citizens Broadband Radio Service Device (CBSD).

[0052] In alternative embodiments, the Industrial, Scientific, and Medical (ISM) radio bands are used instead of CBRS Band 48. It should be noted that the particular frequency bands used in executing the processes herein could be different, and that the aspects of what is disclosed herein should not be limited to a particular frequency band unless otherwise specified (e.g., 4G-LTE or 5G bands could be used). In embodiments, the local network 404 is a private cellular (e.g., LTE) network operated specifically for the benefit of the facility. Only authorized users of the smart radios 424 have access to the local network 404. For example, the local network 404 uses the 900 MHz spectrum. In another example, the local network 404 uses 900 MHz for voice and narrowband data for Land Mobile Radio (LMR) communications, 900 MHz broadband for critical wide area, long-range data communications, and CBRS for ultra-fast

coverage of smaller areas of the facility, such as substations, storage yards, and office spaces.

[0053] The smart radios **424** can communicate using other communication technologies, for example, Voice over IP (VOIP), Voice over Wi-Fi (VoWiFi), or Voice over Long-Term Evolution (VOLTE). The smart radios **424** can connect to a communication session (e.g., voice call, video call) for real-time communication with specific devices. The communication sessions can include devices within or outside of the local network **404** (e.g., in the local network **408**). The communication sessions can be hosted on a private server (e.g., of the local network **404**) or a remote server (e.g., accessible through the cloud computing system **420**). In other aspects, the session can be P2P.

[0054] The cloud computing system **420** delivers computing services—including servers, storage, databases, networking, software, analytics, and intelligence—over the Internet to offer faster innovation, flexible resources, and economies of scale. FIG. 4A depicts an exemplary high-level, cloud-centered network environment **400** otherwise known as a cloud-based system. Referring to FIG. 4A, it can be seen that the environment centers around the cloud computing system **420** and the local networks **404**, **408**. Through the cloud computing system **420**, multiple software systems are made to be accessible by multiple smart radios **424**, **432**, smart cameras **428**, **436**, as well as more standard devices (e.g., a smartphone **440** or a tablet) each equipped with local networking and cellular wireless capabilities. Each of the apparatuses **424**, **428**, **440**, although diverse, can embody the architecture of the apparatus **100** shown by FIG. 1, but are distributed to different kinds of users or mounted on surfaces of the facility. For example, the smart radio **424a** is worn by employees or independently contracted workers at a facility. The CBRS-equipped smartphone **440** is utilized by an on- or offsite supervisor. The smart camera **428** is utilized by an inspector or another person wanting to have improved display or other options. Regardless, it should be recognized that numerous apparatuses are utilized in combination with an established cellular network (e.g., CBRS Band 48 in embodiments) to provide the ability to access the cloud software applications from the apparatuses (e.g., smart radios **424**, **432**, smart cameras **428**, **436**, smartphone **440**).

[0055] In embodiments, the cloud computing system **420** and local networks **404**, **408** are configured to send communications to the smart radios **424**, **432** or smart cameras **428**, **436** based on analysis conducted by the cloud computing system **420**. The communications enable the smart radio **424** or smart camera **428** to receive warnings, etc., generated as a result of analysis conducted. The employee-worn smart radio **424a** (and possibly other devices including the architecture of the apparatus **100**, such as the smart cameras **428**, **436**) is used along with the peripherals shown in FIG. 1 to accomplish a variety of objectives. For example, workers, in embodiments, are equipped with a Bluetooth-enabled gas-detection smart sensor. The smart sensor detects the existence of a dangerous gas, or gas level. By connecting through the smart radio **424a** or directly to the local network **404**, the readings from the smart sensor are analyzed by the cloud computing system **420** to implement a course of action due to sensed characteristics of toxicity. The cloud computing system **420** sends out an alert to the smart radio **424** or smart camera **428**, and thus a worker, for example, uses a speaker or alternative notification means to alert other workers so that they can avoid danger.

Position Estimation

[0056] The environment **400** can include one or more satellites **444**. The smart radios **424** can receive signals from the satellites **444** and/or cellular transmission towers **412** that are usable to determine position estimates. For example, the smart radios **424** include a positioning system that implements a GNSS or other network triangulation/position system. In some embodiments, the locations of the smart radios **424** are determined from satellites, for example, GPS, QZSS, BEIDOU, GALILEO, and GLONASS. In some cases, the position determined from the primary positioning system does not satisfy a minimum accuracy requirement, the primary position can only be determined at predetermined intervals, or the primary position cannot be determined at all. Accordingly, additional positioning techniques can be used to augment or replace primary positioning. For example, the smart radio **424a** can track its position based on broadcast signals received from proximate devices (e.g., using RSSI techniques or TDOA techniques). In some embodiments, the proximate devices include devices that have transmission ranges that encompass the location of the smart radio **424a** (e.g., smart radios **424b**, **424c**). In some embodiments, the smart radios **424** determine or augment a secondary position estimate based on broadcasts received from a cellular communication tower (e.g., cellular transmission tower **412**).

[0057] RSSI techniques include using the strength signals within a broadcast signal to determine the distance of a receiver from a transmitter. For instance, a receiver is enabled to determine the signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) of a received signal within a broadcast from a transmitter. The SNR of receive signal can be related to the distance between a receiver and a transmitter. Thus, the distance between the receiver and the transmitter can be estimated based on the SNR. By determining a receiver's distance from multiple transmitters, the receiver's position can be determined through localization (e.g., triangulation). In some cases, RSSI techniques become less accurate at larger distances. Accordingly, proximate devices may be required to be within a particular distance for RSSI techniques.

[0058] TDOA techniques include using the timing at which broadcast signals are received to determine the distance of a receiver from a transmitter. For example, a broadcast signal is sent by a transmitter at a known time (e.g., predetermined intervals). Thus, by determining the time at which the broadcast signal is received (e.g., using a clock), the travel time of the broadcast signal can be determined. The distance of the smart radios **424** from one another can thus be determined based on the wave speed. In some implementations, as broadcast signals are received from the transmitters, the smart radios **424** determine its relative position from each transmitter through localization, resulting in a more accurate global position (e.g., triangulation). Thus, TDOA techniques can be used to determine device location.

[0059] In aspects, the broadcast signals transmitted by proximate devices include information related to a position. For example, broadcast signals sent from the smart radios **424** identify their current location. Broadcast signals sent from cellular communication towers or other stationary devices may not need to include a current location, as the location may be known to the receiving device. In other cases, a cellular communication tower or other stationary device sends a broadcast signal that includes information

indicative of a current location of the tower or stationary device. Using the current location of the transmitting devices and the location of the smart radios (e.g., smart radios **424b**, **424c**) relative to the transmitting devices, a global position of the smart radio **424a** can be determined.

[0060] In some cases, a barometer is used to augment the position determination of the smart radios **424**. For example, RSSI, TDOA, and other techniques are used to determine the distance between a transmitter and a receiver. However, these techniques may not provide information related to the displacement between the transmitter and the receiver (e.g., whether the distance is in the x, y, or z plane). In some cases, the barometer is used to provide relative displacement information (e.g., based on atmospheric conditions) of the smart radios **424**. In aspects, the broadcast signals received from the proximate devices include information relating to respective elevation estimates (e.g., determined by barometers at the proximate devices) at each of the proximate devices. The elevation estimates from the proximate devices are compared to the elevation estimate of the smart radio **424a** to determine the difference in elevation between the smart radio **424a** and the proximate devices (e.g., smart radios **424b**, **424c**).

[0061] In some cases, a target device estimates a location based on proximate devices without analyzing broadcast signals. For example, proximate devices shares their calculated location data. The target device (e.g., smart radio **424a**) receives location data via any communication technology (e.g., Bluetooth or another short-range communication). One device (e.g., smart radio **424b**) shares that it is at location A and another device (e.g., smart radio **424c**) is at location B. The target device estimates that it's located somewhere near A and B (e.g., within a communication range of A and B using the respective communication mechanism). In another aspect, the target device receives location data from multiple proximate devices and combines (e.g., average) the location data to estimate its position. In yet another example, the target device receives location data from proximate devices via a first communication and uses a second communication to determine the location of the target device relative to the proximate devices. In this way, the location data need not be communicated in the same communication used to determine the relative location of the target device.

[0062] As an example, the smart radio **424b** determines its location based on a primary location estimate that is augmented with a secondary location estimate. For example, the smart radio **424b** receives a primary location estimate. In aspects, the primary location estimate is a GNSS location determined from the satellite **444** or a location estimate determined by communications with the cellular communication tower **412** (e.g., using TDOA, RSSI, or other techniques). In some implementations, the primary location estimate has a measurement error less than 1 foot, 2 feet, 5 feet, 10 feet, or the like. The measurement error may increase based on an environment of the smart radio **424b**. For example, the measurement error may be higher if the smart radio **424b** is within or surrounded by a densely constructed building.

[0063] To improve the measurement accuracy, the smart radio **424b** can augment its primary location estimate based on a secondary location estimate. In aspects, the secondary location estimate is determined from broadcast signals transmitted by smart radio **424a**, smart radio **424c**, smart camera

428, cellular communication tower **412**, or another communication device or node (e.g., an access point). Positioning techniques (e.g., TDOA, RSSI, location sharing, or other techniques) can be used to determine a relative distance from the transmitting device. For example, smart radio **424a**, smart radio **424c**, and smart camera **428** transmit broadcast signals that enable the distance of the smart radio **424b** to be determined relative to each transmitting device. The transmitting devices can be stationary or moving. Stationary objects typically have strong or high confidence location data (e.g., immobile objects are plotted accurately to maps). The relative location of the smart radio **424b** is determined through triangulation based on the distance from each transmitting device. In aspects, the secondary location estimate has a measurement error of less than 1 inch, 2 inches, 6 inches, or 1 foot. In aspects, the secondary location estimate replaces with the primary location estimate or is averaged with the primary location estimate to determine an augmented position estimate with reduced error. Accordingly, the measurement error of the location estimate of the smart device **424b** can be improved by augmenting the primary location estimate with the secondary location estimate.

[0064] In some implementations, the location of the equipment is similarly monitored. In this context, mobile equipment refers to worksite or facility industrial equipment (e.g., heavy machinery, precision tools, construction vehicles). According to example embodiments, a location of a mobile equipment is continuously monitored based on repeated triangulation from multiple smart radios **424** located near the mobile equipment (e.g., using tags placed on the mobile equipment). Improvements to the operation and usage of the mobile equipment are made based on analyzing the locations of the mobile equipment throughout a facility or worksite. Locations of the mobile equipment are reported to owners of the mobile equipment or entities that own, operate, and/or maintain the mobile equipment. Mobile equipment whose location is tracked includes vehicles, tools used and shared by workers in different facility locations, toolkits and toolboxes, manufactured and/or packaged products, and/or the like. Generally, mobile equipment is movable between different locations within the facility or worksite at different points in time.

[0065] Various monitoring operations are performed based on the locations of the mobile equipment that are determined over time. In some embodiments, a usage level for the mobile equipment is automatically classified based on different locations of the mobile equipment over time. For example, a mobile equipment having frequent changes in location within a window of time (e.g., different locations that are at least a threshold distance away from each other) is classified at a high usage level compared to a mobile equipment that remains in approximately the same location for the window of time. In some embodiments, certain mobile equipment classified with high usage levels are indicated and identified to maintenance workers such that usage-related failures or faults can be preemptively identified.

[0066] In some embodiments, a resting or storage location for the mobile equipment is determined based on the monitoring of the mobile equipment location. For example, an average spatial location is determined from the locations of the mobile equipment over time. A storage location based on the average spatial location is then indicated in a recom-

mendation provided or displayed to an administrator or other entity that manages the facility or worksite.

[0067] In some embodiments, locations of multiple mobile equipment are monitored so that a particular mobile equipment is recommended for use to a worker during certain events or scenarios. As another example, for a worker assigned with a maintenance task at a location within a facility, one or more maintenance toolkits shared among workers and located near the location are recommended to the worker for use.

[0068] Accordingly, embodiments described herein provide local detection and monitoring of mobile equipment locations. Facility operation efficiency is improved based on the monitoring of mobile equipment locations and analysis of different mobile equipment locations.

Machine-Defined Interactions

[0069] The cloud computing system **420** uses data received from the smart radios **424**, **432** and smart cameras **428**, **436** to track and monitor machine-defined activity of workers based on locations worked, times worked, analysis of video received from the smart cameras **428**, **436**, etc. The activity is measured by the cloud computing system **420** in terms of at least one of a start time, a duration of the activity, an end time, an identity (e.g., serial number, employee number, name, seniority level, etc.) of the worker performing the activity, an identity of the equipment(s) used by the worker, or a location of the activity. For example, a smart radio **424a** carried or worn by a worker would track that the position of the smart radio **424a** is in proximity to or coincides with a position of the particular machine.

[0070] The activity is measured by the cloud computing system **420** in terms of at least the location of the activity and one of a duration of the activity, an identity of the worker performing the activity, or an identity of the equipment(s) used by the worker. In embodiments, the ML system is used to detect and track activity, for example, by extracting features based on equipment types or manufacturing operation types as input data. For example, a smart sensor mounted on an oil rig transmits to and receives signals from a smart radio **424a** carried or worn by a worker to log the time the worker spends at a portion of the oil rig.

[0071] Positioning of tracked objects further enables identification of hazardous scenarios. Where a given smart radio is approaching another at vehicle speeds (e.g., over 10 miles per hour, over 15 miles per hour, over 20 miles per hour, etc.), a machine defined interaction identifies that the first smart radio is in the possession of someone either driving or riding in a vehicle. When the trajectory of that user (e.g., vector) is identified as directed within a threshold range of another tracked user, the platform identifies the potentially hazardous scenario.

[0072] Worker activity involving multiple workers can similarly be monitored. These activities can be measured by the cloud computing system **420** in terms of at least one of a start time, a duration of the activity, an end time, identities (e.g., serial numbers, employee numbers, names, seniority levels, etc.) of the workers performing the activity, an identity of the equipment(s) used by the workers, or a location of the activity. Group activities are detected and monitored using location tracking of multiple smart apparatuses. For example, the cloud computing system **420** tracks and records a specific group activity based on determining that two or more smart radios **424** were located in

proximity to one another within a particular worksite for a predetermined period of time. For example, a smart radio **424a** transmits to and receives signals from other smart radios **424b**, **424c** carried or worn by other workers to log the time the worker spends working together in a team with the other workers.

[0073] In embodiments, a smart camera **428** mounted at the worksite captures video of one or more workers working in the facility and performs facial recognition (e.g., using the ML system). The smart camera **428** can identify the equipment used to perform an activity or the tasks that a worker is performing. The smart camera **428** sends the location information to the cloud computing system **420** for generation of activity data. In embodiments, an ML system is used to detect and track activity (e.g., using features based on geographic locations or facility types as input data).

[0074] The cloud computing system **420** can determine various metrics for monitored workers based on the activity data. For example, the cloud computing system **420** can determine a response time for a worker. The response time refers to the time difference between receiving a call to report to a given task and the time of arriving at a geofence associated with the task. In aspects, the cloud computing system **420** can determine a repair metric, which measures the effectiveness of repairs by a worker, based on the activity data. For example, the effectiveness of repairs is machine observable based on a length of time a given object remains functional as compared to an expected time of functionality (e.g., a day, a few months, a year, etc.). In yet another aspect, the activity data can be analyzed to determine efficient routes to different areas of a worksite, for example, based on routes traveled by monitored workers. Activity data can be analyzed to determine the risk to which each worker is exposed, for example, based on how much time a worker spends in proximity to hazardous material or performing hazardous tasks. The ML system can analyze the various metrics to monitor workers or reduce risk.

Worker Experience Profile

[0075] The cloud computing system **420** hosts the software functions to track activities to determine performance metrics and time spent at different tasks and with different equipment and to generate work experience profiles of frontline workers based on interfacing between software suites of the cloud computing system **420** and the smart radios **424**, **432**, smart cameras **428**, **436**, smartphone **440**. Tracking of activities is implemented in, for example, Scheduling Systems (SS), Field Data Management (FDM) systems, and/or Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) software systems that are used to track and plan for the use of facility equipment and other resources. Manufacturing Management System (MMS) software is used to manage the production and logistics processes in manufacturing industries (e.g., for the purpose of reducing waste, improving maintenance processes and timing, etc.). Risk-Based Inspection (RBI) software assists the facility using optimized maintenance business processes to examine equipment and/or structures, and track activities prior to and after a breakdown in equipment, detection of manufacturing failures, or detection of operational hazards (e.g., detection of gas leaks in the facility). The amount of time each worker logs at a machine-defined activity with respect to different locations and different types of equipment is collected and used to

update an “experience profile” of the worker on the cloud computing system **420** in real time.

[0076] FIG. 4B is a flow diagram illustrating an example process for generating a work experience profile using smart radios **424a**, **424b**, and local networks **404**, **408** for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments. The smart radios **424** and local networks **404**, **408** are illustrated and described in more detail with reference to FIG. 4A. In embodiments, the process of FIG. 4B is performed by the cloud computing system **420** illustrated and described in more detail with reference to FIG. 4A. In embodiments, the process of FIG. 4A is performed by a computer system, for example, the example computer system illustrated and described in more detail with reference to subsequent figures. Particular entities, for example, the smart radios **424** or the local network **404**, perform some or all of the steps of the process in embodiments. Likewise, embodiments can include different and/or additional steps, or perform the steps in different orders.

[0077] In step **472**, the cloud computing system **420** obtains locations and time-logging information from multiple smart apparatuses (e.g., smart radios **424**) located at a facility. The locations describe movement of the multiple smart apparatuses with respect to the time-logging information. For example, the cloud computing system **420** keeps track of shifts, types of equipment, and locations worked by each worker, and uses the information to develop the experience profile automatically for the worker, including formatting services. When the worker joins an employer or otherwise signs up for the service, relevant personal information is obtained by the cloud computing system **420** to establish payroll and other known employment particulars. The worker uses a smart radio **424a** to engage with the cloud computing system **420** and works shifts for different positions.

[0078] In step **476**, the cloud computing system **420** determines activity of a worker based on the locations and the time-logging information. The activities describe work performed by one or more workers with equipment of the facility (e.g., lathes, lifts, crane, etc.). For example, the activities can include tasks performed by the worker, equipment worked with by the worker, time spent on a task or with a piece of equipment, or any other relevant information. In some cases, the activities can be used to log accidents that occur at the worksite. The activities can also include various performance metrics determined from the location and the time-logging information.

[0079] In step **480**, the cloud computing system **420** generates the experience profile of the worker based on the activity of the worker. The cloud computing system **420** automatically fills in information determined from the activity of the worker to build the experience profile of the worker. The data filled into the field space of the experience profile can include the specific number of hours that a worker has spent working with a particular type of equipment (e.g., 200 hours spent driving forklifts, 150 hours spent operating a lathe, etc.). The experience profile can further include various performance metrics associated with a particular task or piece of equipment. In embodiments, the cloud computing system **420** exports or publishes the experience profile to a user profile of a social or professional networking platform (e.g., such as LinkedIn™, Monster™, any other suitable social media or proprietary website, or a combination thereof). In embodiments, the cloud computing

system **420** exports the experience profile in the form of a recommendation letter or reference package to past or prospective employers. The experience data enables a given worker to prove that they have a certain amount of experience with a given equipment platform.

Example Facility

[0080] FIG. 5 is a drawing illustrating an example facility **500** using apparatuses and communication networks for device communication and tracking, in accordance with one or more embodiments. For example, the facility **500** is a refinery, a manufacturing facility, a construction site, etc. The communication technology shown by FIG. 5 can be implemented using components of the example computer systems illustrated and described in more detail with reference to the other figures herein.

[0081] Multiple differently and strategically placed wireless antennas **574** are used to receive signals from an Internet source (e.g., a fiber backhaul at the facility), or a mobile system (e.g., a truck **502**). The truck **502**, in embodiments, can implement an edge kit used to connect to the Internet. The strategically placed wireless antennas **574** repeat the signals received and sent from the edge kit such that a private cellular network is made available to multiple workers **506**. Each worker carries or wears a cellular-enabled smart radio, implemented in accordance with the embodiments described herein. A position of the smart radio is continually tracked during a work shift.

[0082] In implementations, a stationary, temporary, or permanently installed cellular (e.g., LTE or 5G) source is used that obtains network access through a fiber or cable backhaul. In embodiments, a satellite or other Internet source is embodied into hand-carried or other mobile systems (e.g., a bag, box, or other portable arrangement). FIG. 5 shows that multiple wireless antennas **574** are installed at various locations throughout the facility. Where the edge kit is located at a location near a facility fiber backhaul, the communication system in the facility **500** uses multiple omnidirectional Multi-Band Outdoor (MBO) antennas as shown. Where the Internet source is instead located near an edge of the facility **500**, as is often the case, the communication system uses one or more directional wireless antennas to improve the coverage in terms of bandwidth. Alternatively, where the edge kit is in a mobile vehicle, for example, truck **502**, the antennas' directional configuration would be picked depending on whether the vehicle would ultimately be located at a central or boundary location.

[0083] In embodiments where a backhaul arrangement is installed at the facility **500**, the edge kit is directly connected to an existing fiber router, cable router, or any other source of Internet at the facility. In embodiments, the wireless antennas **574** are deployed at a location in which the smart radio is to be used. For example, the wireless antennas **574** are omnidirectional, directional, or semidirectional depending on the intended coverage area. In embodiments, the wireless antennas **574** support a local cellular network. In embodiments, the local network is a private LTE network (e.g., based on 4G or 5G). In more specific embodiments, the network is a CBRS Band 48 local network. The frequency range for CBRS Band 48 extends from 3550 MHz to 3700 MHz and is executed using TDD as the duplex mode. The private LTE wireless communication device is configured to operate in the private network created, for example, to accommodate CBRS Band 48 in the frequency range for

Band 48 (again, from 3550 MHz to 3700 MHz) and accommodates TDD. Thus, channels within the preferred range are used for different types of communications between the cloud and the local network.

Geofencing

[0084] As described herein, smart radios are configured with location estimating capabilities and are used within a facility or worksite for which geofences are defined. A geofence refers to a virtual perimeter for a real-world geographic area, such as a portion of a facility or worksite. A smart radio includes location-aware devices that inform of the location of the smart radio at various times. Embodiments described herein relate to location-based features for smart radios or smart apparatuses. Location-based features described herein use location data for smart radios to provide improved functionality. In some embodiments, a location of a smart radio (e.g., a position estimate) is assumed to be representative of a location of a worker using or associated with the smart radio. As such, embodiments described herein apply location data for smart radios to perform various functions for workers of a facility or worksite.

[0085] Some example scenarios that require radio communication between workers are area-specific, or relevant to a given area of a facility. For example, when machines need repair, workers near the machine can be notified and provided instructions to assist in the repair. Alternatively, if a hazard is present at the facility, workers near the hazard can be notified.

[0086] According to some embodiments, locations of smart radios are monitored such that at a point in time, each smart radio located in a specific geofenced area is identified. FIG. 6 illustrates an example of a worksite 600 that includes a plurality of geofenced areas 602, with smart radios 605 being located within the geofenced areas 602.

[0087] In some embodiments, an alert, notification, communication, and/or the like is transmitted to each smart radio 605 that is located within a geofenced area 602 (e.g., 602C) responsive to a selection or indication of the geofenced area 602. A smart radio 605, an administrator smart radio (e.g., a smart radio assigned to an administrator), or the cloud computing system is configured to enable user selection of one of the plurality of geofenced areas 602 (e.g., 602C). For example, a map display of the worksite 600 and the plurality of geofenced areas 602 is provided. With the user selection of a geofenced area 602 and a location for each smart radio 605, a set of smart radios 605 located within the geofenced area 602 is identified. An alert, notification, communication, and/or the like is then transmitted to the identified smart radios 605.

ML System

[0088] FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating an example ML system 700, in accordance with one or more embodiments. The ML system 700 can implement one or more components of the computer systems and apparatuses discussed herein. Although illustrated in a particular configuration, different embodiments of the ML system 700 include different and/or additional components and are connected in different ways. The ML system 700 is sometimes referred to as an ML module.

[0089] The ML system 700 includes a feature extraction module 708 implemented using components of an example

computer system, as described herein. In some embodiments, the feature extraction module 708 extracts a feature vector 712 from input data 704. The feature vector 712 includes features 712a, 712b, . . . , 712n. The feature extraction module 708 reduces the redundancy in the input data 704, for example, repetitive data values, to transform the input data 704 into the reduced set of features 712, for example, features 712a, 712b, . . . , 712n. The feature vector 712 contains the relevant information from the input data 704, such that events or data value thresholds of interest are identified by the ML model 716 by using a reduced representation. In some example embodiments, the following dimensionality reduction techniques are used by the feature extraction module 708: independent component analysis, Isomap, principal component analysis (PCA), latent semantic analysis, partial least squares, kernel PCA, multifactor dimensionality reduction, nonlinear dimensionality reduction, multilinear PCA, multilinear subspace learning, semi-definite embedding, autoencoder, and deep feature synthesis.

[0090] In alternate embodiments, the ML model 716 performs deep learning (also known as deep structured learning or hierarchical learning) directly on the input data 704 to learn data representations, as opposed to using task-specific algorithms. In deep learning, no explicit feature extraction is performed; the features 712 are implicitly extracted by the ML system 700. For example, the ML model 716 uses a cascade of multiple layers of nonlinear processing units for implicit feature extraction and transformation. Each successive layer uses the output from the previous layer as input. The ML model 716 thus learns in supervised (e.g., classification) and/or unsupervised (e.g., pattern analysis) modes. The ML model 716 learns multiple levels of representations that correspond to different levels of abstraction, wherein the different levels form a hierarchy of concepts. The multiple levels of representation configure the ML model 716 to differentiate features of interest from background features.

[0091] In alternative example embodiments, the ML model 716, for example, in the form of a convolutional neural network (CNN), generates the output 724, without the need for feature extraction, directly from the input data 704. The output 724 is provided to the computer device 728. The computer device 728 is a server, computer, tablet, smartphone, smart speaker, etc., implemented using components of an example computer system, as described herein. In some embodiments, the steps performed by the ML system 700 are stored in memory on the computer device 728 for execution. In other embodiments, the output 724 is displayed on an apparatus or electronic displays of a cloud computing system.

[0092] A CNN is a type of feed-forward artificial neural network in which the connectivity pattern between its neurons is inspired by the organization of a visual cortex. Individual cortical neurons respond to stimuli in a restricted area of space known as the receptive field. The receptive fields of different neurons partially overlap such that they tile the visual field. The response of an individual neuron to stimuli within its receptive field is approximated mathematically by a convolution operation. CNNs are based on biological processes and are variations of multilayer perceptrons designed to use minimal amounts of preprocessing.

[0093] In embodiments, the ML model 716 is a CNN that includes both convolutional layers and max pooling layers. For example, the architecture of the ML model 716 is “fully

convolutional,” which means that variable sized sensor data vectors are fed into it. For convolutional layers, the ML model 716 specifies a kernel size, a stride of the convolution, and an amount of zero padding applied to the input of that layer. For the pooling layers, the ML model 716 specifies the kernel size and stride of the pooling.

[0094] In some embodiments, the ML system 700 trains the ML model 716, based on the training data 720, to correlate the feature vector 712 to expected outputs in the training data 720. As part of the training of the ML model 716, the ML system 700 forms a training set of features and training labels by identifying a positive training set of features that have been determined to have a desired property in question, and, in some embodiments, forms a negative training set of features that lack the property in question.

[0095] The ML system 700 applies ML techniques to train the ML model 716, such that when applied to the feature vector 712, output indications of whether the feature vector 712 has an associated desired property or properties, such as a probability that the feature vector 712 has a particular Boolean property, or an estimated value of a scalar property. In embodiments, the ML system 700 further applies dimensionality reduction (e.g., via linear discriminant analysis (LDA), PCA, or the like) to reduce the amount of data in the feature vector 712 to a smaller, more representative set of data.

[0096] In embodiments, the ML system 700 uses supervised ML to train the ML model 716, with feature vectors of the positive training set and the negative training set serving as the inputs. In some embodiments, different ML techniques, such as linear support vector machine (linear SVM), boosting for other algorithms (e.g., AdaBoost), logistic regression, naïve Bayes, memory-based learning, random forests, bagged trees, decision trees, boosted trees, boosted stumps, neural networks, CNNs, etc., are used. In some example embodiments, a validation set 732 is formed of additional features, other than those in the training data 720, which have already been determined to have or to lack the property in question. The ML system 700 applies the trained ML model 716 to the features of the validation set 732 to quantify the accuracy of the ML model 716. Common metrics applied in accuracy measurement include Precision and Recall, where Precision refers to a number of results the ML model 716 correctly predicted out of the total it predicted, and Recall is a number of results the ML model 716 correctly predicted out of the total number of features that had the desired property in question. In some embodiments, the ML system 700 iteratively retrain the ML model 716 until the occurrence of a stopping condition, such as the accuracy measurement indication that the ML model 716 is sufficiently accurate, or a number of training rounds having taken place. In embodiments, the validation set 732 includes data corresponding to confirmed locations, dates, times, activities, or combinations thereof. This allows the detected values to be validated using the validation set 732. The validation set 732 is generated based on the analysis to be performed.

Worker Engagement and Safety

[0097] A frontline worker can have a siloed role at a facility even in the presence of other workers. For example, workers on an assembly line are physically proximate to one another but are tasked to handle distinct jobs that do not require communications or engagement with each other. The

lack of engagement can make the work unenjoyable, which increases attrition and creates inefficiencies to replace workers. Existing solutions to improve engagement can include communications devices to share communications among a team, along with messaging platforms on those devices that facilitate communications and gamify engagement from workers with the apps. These existing engagement solutions are ineffective because they fail to create a community among workers at a facility to promote real-world engagement. Moreover, existing engagement solutions are gimmicky and the experience they provide is unnatural.

[0098] Audio for entertainment purposes that is rendered on smart radio devices to workers is typically prohibited or undesired due to safety concerns. In other words, playback of music on smart radio devices used by frontline workers is considered unsafe because the music can distract the workers from performing their work, which can involve operating complex or dangerous machinery. For example, an operator that has unrestricted control over the playback of music is enabled to control the volume and interactions with the music service such that the operator and other adjacent users get distracted and have reduced awareness of their surroundings. Work facilities are often noisy—adding music that is audible either includes headphones that dampen local awareness, or additional loud sound that is audible over the ambient sound.

[0099] Moreover, playback of the music at a high volume poses a health and safety risk because, for example, 85 dB is the maximum recommended exposure limit for human hearing. Moreover, free access to a music service can violate state or federal safety standards.

[0100] Work environments require varying degrees of safety measures including providing notifications and ongoing trainings to workers. Spoken natural language remains a core and effective means for communicating notifications and trainings. However, given the diversity of frontline workers who speak in different languages, keeping workers informed in a timely manner to promote engagement and ensure safety remains challenging. The disclosed technology addresses these drawbacks by promoting engagement of workers with administrative personnel and with other workers through music on smart radios. In particular, music channels provide for simulcasting music to multiple users of radio devices, which increases engagement in a work environment. The music channels have a dual function of also hosting supplemental audio that is delivered to the users. Moreover, the music channel is controlled by the platform to ensure that the music does not pose a safety hazard by controlling volume and playback.

[0101] More specifically, the ability to play music on smart radio devices carried by frontline workers increases the likelihood that the workers will utilize their smart radio devices for audio purposes, which presents an opportunity to interrupt or overlay music with safety notifications. Furthermore, safety notifications can be translated into the native language of the user of the smart radio. For example, an English-speaking worker can receive a safety message spoken in English while a Spanish-speaking worker can receive the same safety message at virtually the same time but spoken in Spanish.

[0102] The music service can include a variety of music channels that can be selected on the smart radios by the workers. As such, the workers can control the music channels that they select. Examples of music channels include

rock, pop, country, hip hop, among others. Once a user selects a music channel, the smart radio device can stream the music from a source that controls the music content, through a platform that controls music playback. In particular, the platform hosts the smart radio devices and, as such, the platform controls playback of the music on the smart radio devices (e.g., how and when the music is rendered). In particular, the platform dynamically controls a user's experience in a location of a facility hosted by the platform. That is, the platform hosting the facility controls music as part of a workflow that can be dependent on the facility, the individual worker, a schedule, and the location of the worker and objects around the worker.

[0103] The playback of music can respond to actions that are performed by the user, that occur in proximity to the user, or that can impact the performance or safety of the user or other workers in the environment. For example, the platform can cause the music channel to pause in response to the presence of people or devices or in particular locations. In one example, the platform can cause a smart radio to mute or pause when the smart radio detects or recognizes a voice of the user or another worker speaking to the user. The platform can use the smart radio device to track the user through a workflow that dynamically adapts playback of the music to reduce the risk of hazards. The platform can also control playback of on a smart radio device to induce an action by the user. For example, the volume and audio can induce the user to react by changing location or starting/stopping a particular task. In one example, a warning can include stopping playback of music, increasing the volume of the audio, and generating siren sounds.

[0104] The smart radio device hosts a secondary app that is controlled by a primary app, which is controlled by the host of smart radios devices at a facility. As such, the primary app can operate like an operating system. The smart radio device can use proximity peer-to-peer communications to inform the user of, for example, how a forklift is moving relative to the user. That is, a first user that has a smart radio device can be notified that a second smart radio device of a second user operating a forklift is on a collision course to the first user. Further, the second smart radio device can use its sensor to determine that the second user is operating the forklift instead of, for example, walking. For example, the radio devices can include motion sensors (e.g., magnetometers, accelerometers) that can detect movements indicative of a forklift. As such, a smart radio can distinguish between one worker approaching another and a forklift approaching a worker.

Music on Radio Architecture

[0105] The smart radio can host management software or have an operating system (OS) that manages access to channels of the music service (e.g., remote root access). In one example, the OS of a smart radio device is specifically designed so that the administrator platform is enabled to control playback of music at the smart radio device (e.g., by controlling the input sources, controlling maximum volume, or input share). That is, the smart radio device operates under the control of the platform to manage playback of the music while allowing the user to select a music channel for playback.

[0106] In another implementation, the music service is controlled by a management app hosted on a smart device or controls that exist within the music streaming application,

where the management app is part of a management system such as a mobile device management (MDM) system. An MDM can be implemented with the use of a third-party product that has management features for particular vendors of mobile devices. The MDM can be a deployment of a combination of on-device applications and configurations, policies and certificates, and backend infrastructure, for the purpose of simplifying and enhancing the IT management of smart devices.

[0107] The disclosed technology can include MDM services that control the playback of music on smart devices as part of workflows for users of the smart devices. The MDM functionality can include over-the-air distribution of applications, data and configuration settings for different types of mobile devices, including smart radios, smartphones, tablet computers, ruggedized mobile computers, etc. The MDM tools can be leveraged for both company-owned and employee-owned (BYOD) devices across the enterprise or mobile devices owned by consumers. By controlling and protecting the data and configuration settings of all mobile devices in a network, the MDM can control playback of music to engage workers while optimizing security.

[0108] In one implementation, the platform is hosted on a server component, which sends out the management commands to control the mobile devices, and a client component, which runs on the managed device and receives and implements the management commands to control playback of music. In some cases, a single vendor provides both the client and the server, while in other cases the client and server are from different sources. As such, the MDM allows control by the platform over the smart device including functions other than the app that provides the music service. For example, the MDM allows the platform to control outputs (e.g., volume) of the phone.

[0109] In some embodiments, the music streaming application itself includes multiple user profiles of differing control—the local user and the remote admin user. The application takes commands from both users, though the remote admin user has higher priority in application commands.

[0110] In another implementation, a mobile application management (MAM) is used, which has more limited capabilities to control a smart device compared to an MDM. The MAM is software that secures and enables control over enterprise applications on smart devices. MAM software allows administrators to apply and enforce policies on mobile apps and limit the sharing of data among apps. The MAM also enables the separation of business apps and data from personal content on the same device. Other MAM features and capabilities include software delivery (e.g., through an enterprise app store), software license management, app configuration, inventory management, and application lifecycle management.

[0111] The MAM allows administrators to apply and enforce policies only on specified apps that access certain data like streaming music, leaving personal apps and data untouched. Some of MAM's functionality is similar to MDM. For example, with MAM, IT can remote wipe an app but not the entire device, as is the case with an MDM-managed device, for example. In some implementations, the smart devices include the MDM and MAM to manage the music service.

[0112] In some embodiments, the administrators have remote hardware controls over each smart radio. Remote

hardware controls operate at the firmware level under the device operating system and enable a remote user to trigger hardware driven signals such as those connected to the physical volume button, or an input selection button. Remote hardware controls function similarly to how a remote control operates a TV or a fan. A corresponding signal is received by the smart device wireless transceiver and that signal is processed as a command outside of the operating system at a hardware level.

[0113] In each of the above embodiments, remotely issued commands are issued either at administrator fiat, or based on automatic trigger conditions that are either locally detected (e.g., smart radio proximity to hazardous situations flags by geofences or by proximity to other tracked objects) or issued based on other wireless commands (e.g., contemporaneously with safety or training announcements)

Remotely Managed Audio Service

[0114] A smart radio device provides a user access to the music service. For example, a touch-sensitive interface can present a graphical control, or the smart radio can have a hardware button that, when actuated, presents options for selecting music channels (e.g., music stations). The smart radio accesses the music channel via an application programming interface (API) of the music service provider. The access to the API is controlled by the platform that hosts smart radios for a facility. As such, the platform controls a smart radio's access to a music channel. Accordingly, the platform can stop/start streaming or interrupt the music to present audio from another source. In another example, the platform can blend audio from the other source to overlay the music. As such, for example, the platform can interrupt or overlay playback of the music to present a safety warning or notification that provides situational awareness to the user. That is, the platform controls how the music will be rendered by the smart radio device. In another implementation, the platform can control how the smart radio renders the music without interrupting the music channel. For example, the platform can control the output of the smart radio to stop/start or interrupt sound generated by the smart radio without interrupting the music streaming to the smart radio device. In yet another implementation, a smart radio device provides local control over playback of music. For example, the smart radio device can stop software from rendering music or mute/attenuate a music channel to present a safety notification.

[0115] The music service that is controlled by the platform can be provided to smart radios by using different communications technology. Generally, the audio service administers one or more audio streams (e.g., media such as music) that is delivered synchronously to multiple smart radios such that users have a shared music experience.

[0116] An encoded audio stream can include a series of key frames and prediction frames. A key frame can represent a full frame of the media. In operation, a smart radio device can process a first key frame to render the corresponding media content. Key frames can be decoded without reference to any other frame in a sequence, where the decoder reconstructs such frames beginning from the decoder's "default" state. The prediction frames succeed the key frame and represent differences between the key frame, which can lower the required data to render the frame represented by the predicted frame. In many cases, the correct decoding of

a predictive frame depends on the correct decoding of the most recent key frame and all ensuing predictive frames.

[0117] A media stream can be encoded using an encoding technique, such as chunked transfer encoding to create chunks (i.e., divided and non-overlapping portions of the media stream). Chunks of encoded media stream can be transmitted and received independently of one another. In some embodiments, both the recipient and the sender of the chunk-based stream may not need to know of the data stream outside of the chunk currently being processed.

[0118] The disclosed technology can enable adaptive bitrate streaming with multiple subscribers to the same music channel. As an example, radio A can subscribe to the encoded media stream at time T0. Radio B can subscribe at time T1. In some embodiments, if the encoded stream utilizes adaptive bitrate streaming, each distribution layer of the stream can previously be encoded. A new radio (e.g., radio B) subscribing to the already broadcasting encoded stream requests a new key frame at a specific resolution. In many cases, the radio B can request the encoded media stream at a subscription time before the arrival of a new key frame at time T2 in relation to the time domain.

[0119] In response to changing network conditions, a smart radio device can request changing the bitrate of an encoded media stream to adapt to the changing network conditions. However, to subscribe to another distribution layer, the radio device may have to wait until a new key frame for the requested distribution layer arrives. Accordingly, the duration between the first time and the second time represents a time duration where bandwidth is underutilized.

Geofencing

[0120] A smart radio device can be configured to perform an action that manages a music service in response to a smart radio device approaching or passing a geofenced region. For example, the disclosed technology can determine the location of a smart radio device and respond as the smart radio device that approaches or leaves a geofenced area. In particular, the system can implement rules that respond to a smart radio device leaving or approaching a geofenced area. For example, the volume can be controlled to lower or raise in response to the location of the smart radio device being near a geofenced area. The system can detect the location of the smart radio device to be inside or outside of a geofenced area and respond accordingly.

[0121] The platform can host different facilities that each implement policies (e.g., including rulesets) that depends on the type of facility. As such, the platform can implement different rulesets for different facilities. In one example, a first facility where workers primarily operate sewing machines might implement a less restrictive ruleset compared to a second facility that assembles automobiles. The ruleset for the first facility can allow users control over access to the music service and the way in which music is rendered (e.g., volume control). In contrast, the ruleset for the second facility could deny users any control over volume. That is, the volume for any particular smart device within the facility would be controlled by the platform that hosts the ruleset for the facility.

[0122] The platform that hosts the different facilities can partition an area of a particular facility into zones that are defined with geofencing. As such, the platform can implement different rulesets for different zones. In one example, a facility can have different zone types of varying risk or

safety levels such as high, medium, or low. The facility can have distinct areas that are designated at one level and other areas that are designated at other levels. For example, an area in which there is dangerous machinery used to assemble products can be designated as “high risk” while the lunch-room area can be designated as “low risk.” The ruleset for the high-risk zone can remove certain local controls from a smart radio device compared to the low-risk zone. As such, a smart radio can dynamically adapt to manage a workflow that implements different rulesets in different zones as an operator of the smart radio travels throughout the facility. For example, the platform can limit the volume to a maximum of 85 dB throughout the facility, fix the volume to a particular level in the high-risk zone, and allow the user to manually control the volume when they enter the lunch-room.

Proximate Device Detection

[0123] The system can modify playback of audio (e.g., music stream) at a smart radio device based on its location relative to the location of another device. That is, a smart radio device that is rendering audio can respond to the relative location of another smart radio device and/or another type of device or machine. For example, a first smart radio device can recognize the presence of a second smart radio device and respond by, for example, changing a parameter of playback on the first smart radio device. In one example, the first smart radio device can detect that the second smart radio device is approaching and, in response, stop playback or reduce the volume of playback temporarily. As such, the first smart radio device anticipates that a user of the second smart radio device is approaching to potentially engage in a verbal dialog that would require attention. By stopping playback or attenuating the sound, a user is not only notified of the approaching coworker but also can hear what the coworker might say. The first smart radio device can respond similarly to its user approaching the second smart radio device. In other words, a smart radio device can respond to the presence of another smart radio device, as well as the changing distance between the two.

[0124] A smart radio device can also respond to a device other than another smart radio device. As such, the smart radio device can respond to the presence of a machine or an IoT device equipped to send a signal that can be detected by the smart radio device as an indication of the presence of the machine or device. For example, a forklift that is quipped with an emitter indicative of its presence can be detected by a smart radio device to avoid a hazard of the operator being hurt by the forklift.

Loudspeaker-Type Dependent Controls

[0125] The configuration of music service that is available to a user of a smart radio device can depend on the type of loudspeaker device that the user connects to the smart radio device. Types of loudspeaker devices include over-ear headphones, on-ear headphones, earbuds, noise-canceling headphones, bone conduction headphones, boom mics, stand-alone speakers, speakers integrated in smart radio devices, etc. The smart radio device can connect to the loudspeaker device wirelessly or a wired means to generate sound from the smart radio device.

[0126] Once a user of a smart radio device connects a loudspeaker, the smart radio can detect the type of speaker

using a variety of known methods and implement policies that is specific for the type of loudspeaker. For example, the policies for a boom mic might have a higher threshold maximum permitted volume compared to policies for an over-ear headphone. Certain rules of policies can be implemented depending on the capabilities of the particular type of loudspeaker. For example, the smart radio device can detect that a particular type of headphone has a noise canceling feature and, in response, implement a rule to disable or enable noise canceling in response to the presence of a device or to the user being in a particular zone.

Automatic User Customization

[0127] The system can be controlled by the platform to customize the experience and safety features for specific users. That is, the smart radio can adapt to a user’s specific needs, condition, or situation. For example, content delivered to the user of a smart device, distinct from a music stream, can be configured for that user. Examples include notifications that are delivered in a language that is native to the user or additional content for users that are newer to a job and require additional feedback. As such, content can be delivered to train a user depending on the user’s experience level.

[0128] The disclosed technology can implement a generative artificial intelligence (genAI) system to create content that is customized for a user. A technical description of the genAI system is described with respect to FIG. 10. The generated content can include safety messages including language conversion of notifications that overlay music. For example, a genAI system can be trained based on model data of a type of facility and include profiles of workers having specific roles for that facility. For example, a first model can be trained for an oil and gas plant and a second model can be trained for a food packing plant. The models can include data about the types of machines in devices found in the facility, as well as the roles and workflows of workers in the facilities. The model can be trained to output content that is customized for user based on input including sensor data from the smart radio device. For example, a smart radio device can detect an approaching device aboard a forklift and generate an audio message such as “forklift approaching behind you,” which is overlaid into the music being played as notification. As such, the music on the smart radio device can engage the worker and the genAI platform can customize the notifications to a user of the smart radio device, to improve the situational awareness of the user.

[0129] FIG. 8 is a diagram that illustrates a process 800 for controlling playback of music at smart radio devices. The process can be performed by a server system that hosts a platform that controls the smart radio devices. For example, a smart radio device can be configured to host a mobile app that enables the user of the smart radio device to select the music channel from among multiple available music channels for playback through the loudspeaker coupled to the smart radio device.

[0130] Referring back to FIG. 8, At 802, the platform enables users of smart radio devices to select music channels for playback through loudspeakers coupled to the smart radio devices. Each smart radio is configured for two-way communication and belongs to a group of smart radio devices associated with a facility. The platform can enable simulcast of a first music of a first music channel across a first subset of smart radio devices of the group of smart radio

devices. The platform can also enable simulcast of a second music of a second music channel across a second subset of smart radio devices different from the first subset. The platform can cause the first subset to present a first indication that each smart radio belongs to the first subset and cause the second subset of smart radio devices to present a second indication different than the first. For example, the first indication can be LED lights that emit one color or pattern of light and the second indication can be LED lights that emit another color or another pattern of light. The indications can be anything perceivable to people who are not users of any of the group of smart radio devices.

[0131] At 804, the platform sets one or more parameter(s) for playback of music at the smart radio device in accordance with one or more rule(s) that is implemented for the facility. In one example, the rule(s) is a ruleset selected from among multiple rulesets for a type of loudspeaker corresponding to over-ear headphones, on-ear headphones, earbuds, noise-canceling headphones, bone conduction headphones, boom mics, standalone speakers, or speakers integrated in smart radio devices. The platform can dynamically control parameter(s) of playback of the music responsive to a workflow including presence of the user in geofenced locations of the facility and presence of devices in a threshold proximity to the smart radio device. The parameter(s) are controlled by the platform hosted on the server system via an operating system, mobile device management app, or mobile application management app that is hosted on the smart radio device.

[0132] At 806, the platform causes the smart radio device to respond to an event detected at the smart radio device by performing an action. The event is based on a user identity, a user responsibilities, a user job role, a location of the smart radio device relative to a geofenced area (e.g., zones 1, 2, 3) of the facility or presence of a device, equipment, or machine in a threshold vicinity of the smart radio device. Performing the action includes modifying a value of the parameter(s) of playback of music.

[0133] At 808, the platform optionally causes the smart radio device to restore the value of the parameter(s) of playback of music in response to detecting that the event ended or after expiration of a time period that began when the event was detected. In one example, performing the action includes causing the smart radio device to interrupt playback of the music on the music channel for a time period and instead playback an audio notification during the time period. In another example, performing the action includes causing the smart radio to attenuate volume of the music on the music channel for a time period and playback an audio notification during the time period to overlay the attenuated music. In another example, performing the action includes attenuating the volume of the music for a time period and playback an audio notification during the time period to overlay the attenuated music.

[0134] In another example, performing the action includes causing the smart radio device to select an audio notification for playback during or instead of the music being rendered on the smart radio device, translating the audio notification into a preferred language of the user as indicated in a profile of the user, and playing back an audio notification to interrupt or overlay the music. In yet another example, performing the action includes causing the smart radio device to generate, based on a genAI system, an audio notification for playback during or instead of the music

being rendered on the smart radio device. The audio notification is generated based on a profile of the user and a profile of the facility, for example.

[0135] FIG. 9 is a diagram that illustrates a process 900 for controlling volume of music at smart radio devices remotely. At 902, an administrative platform authenticates a smart radio. In practice, many smart radios are authenticated by the platform. The smart radios operate as client devices on the network. The smart radios include a speaker, a wireless transceiver, a streaming audio application, and a volume setting associated with the streaming audio application. The streaming audio application enables the user to play music through the speaker of their smart radio, and connection to the administrative platform enables communication (e.g., audio and/or text) between users. Examples of the streaming music applications that exist at the time of this disclosure include iHeartRadio, Spotify, Slacker, TuneIn, TIDAL, Pandora, or other suitable applications known in the art.

[0136] In step 904, an event occurs that is tracked by the administrative platform, such as a safety event associated with a user of the smart radio. Safety events include announcements that would be delivered by audio on the smart radio such as notices of hazards on a given facility/worksites, announcements of safety inspections, announcements of downtime of equipment, announcement that tracked machinery is approaching the user (e.g., as detected via location tracking of the smart radio and the tracked machinery), and other safety related notices known in the art.

[0137] Another example of a detected event includes messages (e.g., between users) received by the user of the smart radio. For example, a user messages a given user via two-way communications, and the message is read allowed locally on the given user's smart radio. In response to said receiving of the audio message, the smart radio automatically reduces the volume setting of the streaming audio application while the audio message plays simultaneously through the speaker of the smart radio.

[0138] The detection of these events is connected to an adjustment of the volume control of the streaming audio application. That is, a safety concern of allowing music to play at a work facility where there are dangerous hazards present is that music reduces awareness of workers. Providing an administrator external control of the volume of that music for when an important notice needs to be issued enables safe listening of music by workers (and improved resulting morale of said workers).

[0139] In step 906, in response to said identification of the event, transmitting a remote signal from the administrative platform toward the smart radio. The remote signal is configured to cause the smart radio to reduce the volume setting of the streaming audio application. The reduction in volume enables the audio message associated with the event to play uninterrupted by the music. Alternatively, reduction in the music volume enables the local user to better hear/perceive their immediate surroundings (e.g., such as hearing motorized vehicles approaching their position).

[0140] In step 908, the volume of the streaming music application is reduced. In some embodiments, the manner or amount of volume reduction is based on the detected event. For example, where the event is a safety message music may be muted while the safety message plays, where the event is an approaching vehicle, the music may be muted while the vehicle is in the vicinity, where a user receives an incoming

message, the music may simply be reduced in volume while the smart radio reads out the message audibly. In step 910, the audio message connected to the detected event plays or the event that requires the local user's attention occurs. In step 912, after the audio message connected to the detected event or the event itself is over, the volume setting for the streaming music application is returned to the previous setting and the user is able to continue enjoying their chosen music.

[0141] The modification of the volume setting of the streaming audio application is implemented in a number of different embodiments. In some embodiments, the control signal modifies a media volume setting of the smart radio. Some cell phone devices have separate volume settings for calls and for media, the volume modification works similarly, though operated by a remote administrative signal that is not avoidable/reversible by the local user. When the local user has control over the volume setting, that user may deem that the safety message is less important than their music and ignore it, thus remote, and mandatory control over the volume disables the local user from making that decision. The mandatory controls may exist at a firmware level (e.g., control over the speaker), an operating system level (e.g., control of access to system resources), or an application level (e.g., creating limits within the application settings). At the firmware level, the modification employs a hardware circuit within the smart radio that is triggered by the remote signal.

[0142] The application level settings include both remote control of a local administration application or remote control of the streaming audio application itself. In these embodiments, the streaming audio application's volume is reduced fully to zero or minimized while another audio message is played at a louder volume over the reduced music volume.

[0143] Another embodiment of volume adjustment includes toggling the "aux" setting of the smart radio and changing the audio input channel. That is, shifting input of the speakers from the streaming audio application instead to another application (e.g., that plays the safety message).

[0144] FIG. 10 is a block diagram of an example transformer 1012. A transformer is a type of neural network architecture that uses self-attention mechanisms to generate predicted output based on input data that has some sequential meaning (e.g., the order of the input data is meaningful, which is the case for most text input). Self-attention is a mechanism that relates different positions of a single sequence to compute a representation of the same sequence. Although transformer-based language models are described herein, the present disclosure may be applicable to any ML-based language model, including language models based on other neural network architectures such as recurrent neural network (RNN)-based language models.

[0145] The transformer 1012 includes an encoder 1008 (which can include one or more encoder layers/blocks connected in series) and a decoder 1010 (which can include one or more decoder layers/blocks connected in series). Generally, the encoder 1008 and the decoder 1010 each include multiple neural network layers, at least one of which can be a self-attention layer. The parameters of the neural network layers can be referred to as the parameters of the language model.

[0146] The transformer 1012 can be trained to perform certain functions on a natural language input. Examples of

the functions include summarizing existing content, brainstorming ideas, writing a rough draft, fixing spelling and grammar, and translating content. Summarizing can include extracting key points or themes from an existing content in a high-level summary. Brainstorming ideas can include generating a list of ideas based on provided input. For example, the ML model can generate a list of names for a startup or costumes for an upcoming party. Writing a rough draft can include generating writing in a particular style that could be useful as a starting point for the user's writing. The style can be identified as, e.g., an email, a blog post, a social media post, or a poem. Fixing spelling and grammar can include correcting errors in an existing input text. Translating can include converting an existing input text into a variety of different languages. In some implementations, the transformer 1012 is trained to perform certain functions on other input formats than natural language input. For example, the input can include objects, images, audio content, or video content, or a combination thereof.

[0147] The transformer 1012 can be trained on a text corpus that is labeled (e.g., annotated to indicate verbs, nouns) or unlabeled. LLMs can be trained on a large unlabeled corpus. The term "language model," as used herein, can include an ML-based language model (e.g., a language model that is implemented using a neural network or other ML architecture), unless stated otherwise. Some LLMs can be trained on a large multi-language, multi-domain corpus to enable the model to be versatile at a variety of language-based tasks such as generative tasks (e.g., generating human-like natural language responses to natural language input).

[0148] FIG. 10 illustrates an example 1000 of how the transformer 1012 can process textual input data. Input to a language model (whether transformer-based or otherwise) typically is in the form of natural language that can be parsed into tokens. The term "token" in the context of language models and NLP has a different meaning from the use of the same term in other contexts such as data security. Tokenization, in the context of language models and NLP, refers to the process of parsing textual input (e.g., a character, a word, a phrase, a sentence, a paragraph) into a sequence of shorter segments that are converted to numerical representations referred to as tokens (or "compute tokens"). Typically, a token can be an integer that corresponds to the index of a text segment (e.g., a word) in a vocabulary dataset. Often, the vocabulary dataset is arranged by frequency of use. Commonly occurring text, such as punctuation, can have a lower vocabulary index in the dataset and thus be represented by a token having a smaller integer value than less commonly occurring text. Tokens frequently correspond to words, with or without white space appended. In some implementations, a token can correspond to a portion of a word.

[0149] For example, the word "greater" can be represented by a token for [great] and a second token for [er]. In another example, the text sequence "write a summary" can be parsed into the segments [write], [a], and [summary], each of which can be represented by a respective numerical token. In addition to tokens that are parsed from the textual sequence (e.g., tokens that correspond to words and punctuation), there can also be special tokens to encode non-textual information. For example, a [CLASS] token can be a special token that corresponds to a classification of the textual sequence (e.g., can classify the textual sequence as a list, a paragraph), an [EOT] token can be another special token that

indicates the end of the textual sequence, other tokens can provide formatting information, etc.

[0150] In FIG. 10, a short sequence of tokens **1002** corresponding to the input text is illustrated as input to the transformer **1012**. Tokenization of the text sequence into the tokens **1002** can be performed by some pre-processing tokenization module such as, for example, a byte-pair encoding tokenizer (the “pre” referring to the tokenization occurring prior to the processing of the tokenized input by the LLM), which is not shown in FIG. 10 for brevity. In general, the token sequence that is inputted to the transformer **1012** can be of any length up to a maximum length defined based on the dimensions of the transformer **1012**. Each token **1002** in the token sequence is converted into an embedding vector **1006** (also referred to as “embedding **1006**”).

[0151] An embedding **1006** is a learned numerical representation (such as, for example, a vector) of a token that captures some semantic meaning of the text segment represented by the token **1002**. The embedding **1006** represents the text segment corresponding to the token **1002** in a way such that embeddings corresponding to semantically related text are closer to each other in a vector space than embeddings corresponding to semantically unrelated text. For example, assuming that the words “write,” “a,” and “summary” each correspond to, respectively, a “write” token, an “a” token, and a “summary” token when tokenized, the embedding **1006** corresponding to the “write” token will be closer to another embedding corresponding to the “jot down” token in the vector space as compared to the distance between the embedding **1006** corresponding to the “write” token and another embedding corresponding to the “summary” token.

[0152] The vector space can be defined by the dimensions and values of the embedding vectors. Various techniques can be used to convert a token **1002** to an embedding **1006**. For example, another trained ML model can be used to convert the token **1002** into an embedding **1006**. In particular, another trained ML model can be used to convert the token **1002** into an embedding **1006** in a way that encodes additional information into the embedding **1006** (e.g., a trained ML model can encode positional information about the position of the token **1002** in the text sequence into the embedding **1006**). In some implementations, the numerical value of the token **1002** can be used to look up the corresponding embedding in an embedding matrix **1004**, which can be learned during training of the transformer **1012**.

[0153] The generated embeddings **1006** are input into the encoder **1008**. The encoder **1008** serves to encode the embeddings **1006** into feature vectors **1014** that represent the latent features of the embeddings **1006**. The encoder **1008** can encode positional information (i.e., information about the sequence of the input) in the feature vectors **1014**. The feature vectors **1014** can have very high dimensionality (e.g., on the order of thousands or tens of thousands), with each element in a feature vector **1014** corresponding to a respective feature. The numerical weight of each element in a feature vector **1014** represents the importance of the corresponding feature. The space of all possible feature vectors **1014** that can be generated by the encoder **1008** can be referred to as a latent space or feature space.

[0154] Conceptually, the decoder **1010** is designed to map the features represented by the feature vectors **1014** into meaningful output, which can depend on the task that was

assigned to the transformer **1012**. For example, if the transformer **1012** is used for a translation task, the decoder **1010** can map the feature vectors **1014** into text output in a target language different from the language of the original tokens **1002**. Generally, in a generative language model, the decoder **1010** serves to decode the feature vectors **1014** into a sequence of tokens. The decoder **1010** can generate output tokens **1016** one by one. Each output token **1016** can be fed back as input to the decoder **1010** in order to generate the next output token **1016**. By feeding back the generated output and applying self-attention, the decoder **1010** can generate a sequence of output tokens **1016** that has sequential meaning (e.g., the resulting output text sequence is understandable as a sentence and obeys grammatical rules). The decoder **1010** can generate output tokens **1016** until a special [EOT] token (indicating the end of the text) is generated. The resulting sequence of output tokens **1016** can then be converted to a text sequence in post-processing. For example, each output token **1016** can be an integer number that corresponds to a vocabulary index. By looking up the text segment using the vocabulary index, the text segment corresponding to each output token **1016** can be retrieved, the text segments can be concatenated together, and the final output text sequence can be obtained.

[0155] In some implementations, the input provided to the transformer **1012** includes instructions to perform a function on an existing text. The output can include, for example, a modified version of the input text and instructions to modify the text. The modification can include summarizing, translating, correcting grammar or spelling, changing the style of the input text, lengthening or shortening the text, or changing the format of the text (e.g., adding bullet points or checkboxes). As an example, the input text can include meeting notes prepared by a user and the output can include a high-level summary of the meeting notes. In other examples, the input provided to the transformer includes a question or a request to generate text. The output can include a response to the question, text associated with the request, or a list of ideas associated with the request. For example, the input can include the question “What is the weather like in San Francisco?” and the output can include a description of the weather in San Francisco. As another example, the input can include a request to brainstorm names for a flower shop and the output can include a list of relevant names.

[0156] Although a general transformer architecture for a language model and its theory of operation have been described above, this is not intended to be limiting. Existing language models include language models that are based only on the encoder of the transformer or only on the decoder of the transformer. An encoder-only language model encodes the input text sequence into feature vectors that can then be further processed by a task-specific layer (e.g., a classification layer). BERT is an example of a language model that can be considered to be an encoder-only language model. A decoder-only language model accepts embeddings as input and can use auto-regression to generate an output text sequence. Transformer-XL and GPT-type models can be language models that are considered to be decoder-only language models.

[0157] Because GPT-type language models tend to have a large number of parameters, these language models can be considered LLMs. An example of a GPT-type LLM is GPT-3. GPT-3 is a type of GPT language model that has been trained (in an unsupervised manner) on a large corpus

derived from documents available online to the public. GPT-3 has a very large number of learned parameters (on the order of hundreds of billions), can accept a large number of tokens as input (e.g., up to 2,048 input tokens), and is able to generate a large number of tokens as output (e.g., up to 2,048 tokens). GPT-3 has been trained as a generative model, meaning that it can process input text sequences to predictively generate a meaningful output text sequence. ChatGPT is built on top of a GPT-type LLM and has been fine-tuned with training datasets based on text-based chats (e.g., chatbot conversations). ChatGPT is designed for processing natural language, receiving chat-like inputs, and generating chat-like outputs.

[0158] A computer system can access a remote language model (e.g., a cloud-based language model), such as ChatGPT or GPT-3, via a software interface (e.g., an API). Additionally or alternatively, such a remote language model can be accessed via a network such as the Internet. In some implementations, such as, for example, potentially in the case of a cloud-based language model, a remote language model can be hosted by a computer system that can include a plurality of cooperating (e.g., cooperating via a network) computer systems that can be in, for example, a distributed arrangement. Notably, a remote language model can employ multiple processors (e.g., hardware processors such as, for example, processors of cooperating computer systems). Indeed, processing of inputs by an LLM can be computationally expensive/can involve a large number of operations (e.g., many instructions can be executed/large data structures can be accessed from memory), and providing output in a required timeframe (e.g., real time or near real time) can require the use of a plurality of processors/cooperating computing devices as discussed above.

[0159] Inputs to an LLM can be referred to as a prompt, which is a natural language input that includes instructions to the LLM to generate a desired output. A computer system can generate a prompt that is provided as input to the LLM via an API. As described above, the prompt can optionally be processed or pre-processed into a token sequence prior to being provided as input to the LLM via its API. A prompt can include one or more examples of the desired output, which provides the LLM with additional information to enable the LLM to generate output according to the desired output. Additionally or alternatively, the examples included in a prompt can provide inputs (e.g., example inputs) corresponding to/as can be expected to result in the desired outputs provided. A one-shot prompt refers to a prompt that includes one example, and a few-shot prompt refers to a prompt that includes multiple examples. A prompt that includes no examples can be referred to as a zero-shot prompt.

Computing System

[0160] FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating an example computer system 1100, in accordance with one or more embodiments. At least some operations described herein are implemented on the computer system 1100. The computer system 1100 includes one or more central processing units (“processors”) 1102, main memory 1106, non-volatile memory 1110, network adapters 1112 (e.g., network interface), video displays 1118, input/output devices 1120, control devices 1122 (e.g., keyboard and pointing devices), drive units 1124 including a storage medium 1126, and a signal generation device 1130 that are communicatively

connected to a bus 1116. The bus 1116 is illustrated as an abstraction that represents one or more physical buses and/or point-to-point connections that are connected by appropriate bridges, adapters, or controllers. In embodiments, the bus 1116 includes a system bus, a Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) bus or PCI-Express bus, a HyperTransport or industry standard architecture (ISA) bus, a small computer system interface (SCSI) bus, a universal serial bus (USB), an IIC (I2C) bus, or an IEEE standard 1394 bus (also referred to as “Firewire”).

[0161] In embodiments, the computer system 1100 shares a similar computer processor architecture as that of a desktop computer, tablet computer, personal digital assistant (PDA), mobile phone, game console, music player, wearable electronic device (e.g., a watch or fitness tracker), network-connected (“smart”) device (e.g., a television or home assistant device), virtual/augmented reality systems (e.g., a head-mounted display), or another electronic device capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify action(s) to be taken by the computer system 1100.

[0162] While the main memory 1106, non-volatile memory 1110, and storage medium 1126 (also called a “machine-readable medium”) are shown to be a single medium, the terms “machine-readable medium” and “storage medium” should be taken to include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized/distributed database and/or associated caches and servers) that store one or more sets of instructions 1128. The terms “machine-readable medium” and “storage medium” shall also be taken to include any medium that is capable of storing, encoding, or carrying a set of instructions for execution by the computer system 1100.

[0163] In general, the routines executed to implement the embodiments of the disclosure are implemented as part of an operating system or a specific application, component, program, object, module, or sequence of instructions (collectively referred to as “computer programs”). The computer programs typically include one or more instructions (e.g., instructions 1104, 1108, 1128) set at various times in various memory and storage devices in a computer device. When read and executed by the one or more processors 1102, the instruction(s) cause the computer system 1100 to perform operations to execute elements involving the various aspects of the disclosure.

[0164] Moreover, while embodiments have been described in the context of fully functioning computer devices, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the various embodiments are capable of being distributed as a program product in a variety of forms. The disclosure applies regardless of the particular type of machine or computer-readable media used to actually effect the distribution.

[0165] Further examples of machine-readable storage media, machine-readable media, or computer-readable media include recordable-type media such as volatile and non-volatile memory devices 1110, floppy and other removable disks, hard disk drives, optical discs (e.g., Compact Disc Read-Only Memory (CD-ROMs), Digital Versatile Discs (DVDs)), and transmission-type media such as digital and analog communication links.

[0166] The network adapter 1112 enables the computer system 1100 to mediate data in a network 1114 with an entity that is external to the computer system 1100 through any communication protocol supported by the computer system

1100 and the external entity. In embodiments, the network adapter **1112** includes a network adapter card, a wireless network interface card, a router, an access point, a wireless router, a switch, a multilayer switch, a protocol converter, a gateway, a bridge, a bridge router, a hub, a digital media receiver, and/or a repeater.

[0167] In embodiments, the network adapter **1112** includes a firewall that governs and/or manages permission to access proxy data in a computer network and tracks varying levels of trust between different machines and/or applications. In embodiments, the firewall is any number of modules having any combination of hardware and/or software components able to enforce a predetermined set of access rights between a particular set of machines and applications, machines and machines, and/or applications and applications (e.g., to regulate the flow of traffic and resource sharing between these entities). The firewall additionally manages and/or has access to an access control list that details permissions including the access and operation rights of an object by an individual, a machine, and/or an application, and the circumstances under which the permission rights stand.

[0168] In embodiments, the functions performed in the processes and methods are implemented in differing order. Furthermore, the outlined steps and operations are only provided as examples. For example, some of the steps and operations are optional, combined into fewer steps and operations, or expanded into additional steps and operations without detracting from the essence of the disclosed embodiments.

[0169] In embodiments, the techniques introduced here are implemented by programmable circuitry (e.g., one or more microprocessors), software and/or firmware, special-purpose hardwired (i.e., non-programmable) circuitry, or a combination of such forms. In embodiments, special-purpose circuitry is in the form of one or more application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), programmable logic devices (PLDs), field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), etc.

[0170] The description and drawings herein are illustrative and are not to be construed as limiting. Numerous specific details are described to provide a thorough understanding of the disclosure. However, in certain instances, well-known details are not described in order to avoid obscuring the description. Further, various modifications can be made without deviating from the scope of the embodiments.

[0171] The terms used in this specification generally have their ordinary meanings in the art, within the context of the disclosure, and in the specific context where each term is used. Certain terms that are used to describe the disclosure are discussed above, or elsewhere in the specification, to provide additional guidance to the practitioner regarding the description of the disclosure. It will be appreciated that the same thing can be said in more than one way. One will recognize that “memory” is one form of a “storage” and that the terms are on occasion used interchangeably.

[0172] Consequently, alternative language and synonyms are used for any one or more of the terms discussed herein, and no special significance is to be placed upon whether or not a term is elaborated or discussed herein. Synonyms for certain terms are provided. A recital of one or more synonyms does not exclude the use of other synonyms. The use of examples anywhere in this specification, including examples of any term discussed herein, is illustrative only and is not intended to further limit the scope and meaning of

the disclosure or of any exemplified term. Likewise, the disclosure is not limited to various embodiments given in this specification.

1. A method of remotely regulating audio output of a radio device, comprising:

authenticating a smart radio with an administrative platform that is separate from the smart radio, wherein the smart radio includes a speaker, a wireless transceiver, a streaming audio application, and a volume setting associated with the streaming audio application;

identifying a safety event associated with a user of the smart radio; and

in response to said identification of the safety event, transmitting a remote signal from the administrative platform toward the smart radio, the remote signal configured to cause the smart radio to reduce the volume setting of the streaming audio application.

2. The method of claim **1**, wherein the remote signal is configured to be processed by an operating system employing root access to the smart radio and wherein the operating system reduces the volume setting.

3. The method of claim **1**, wherein the remote signal is configured to be processed by a local administrator program on the smart radio that includes administrative privileges that enable reducing the volume setting.

4. The method of claim **1**, wherein the remote signal is configured to be acted upon by a hardware circuit of the smart radio that causes a reduction to the volume setting.

5. The method of claim **1**, wherein the remote signal is configured to be received by the streaming audio application and the authenticating of the smart radio enables the administrative platform with control over the streaming audio application and causes a reduction to the volume setting.

6. The method of claim **1**, further comprising:

transmitting an audio safety notice toward the smart radio; and

remotely causing the smart radio to play the audio safety notice at a volume higher than the reduces the volume setting of the streaming audio application.

7. The method of claim **1**, further comprising:

operating the wireless transceiver of the smart radio with two-way communications with a plurality of other smart radio devices that are each authenticated with the administrative platform;

receiving, by the smart radio, an audio message via the two-way communications associated with the user of the smart radio; and

in response to said receiving of the audio message, automatically reducing the volume setting of the streaming audio application while the audio message plays simultaneously through the speaker of the smart radio.

8. The method of claim **1**, wherein the remote signal that is configured to cause the smart radio to reduce the volume setting of the streaming audio application further modifies an audio input channel away from the streaming audio application to a safety channel.

9. A method of remotely regulating audio output of a radio device, comprising:

authenticating a smart radio with an administrative platform that is separate from the smart radio, wherein the smart radio includes a speaker, a wireless transceiver, a streaming audio application, and a volume setting associated with the streaming audio application;

operating a transceiver of the smart radio with two-way communications with a plurality of other smart radio devices that are each authenticated with the administrative platform;

receiving, by the smart radio, an audio message via the two-way communications associated with a user of the smart radio; and

in response to said receiving of the audio message, automatically reducing the volume setting of the streaming audio application while the audio message plays simultaneously through the speaker of the smart radio.

10. The method of claim **9**, wherein the audio message is configured to be processed by an operating system employing root access to the smart radio and wherein the operating system reduces the volume setting.

11. The method of claim **9**, wherein the audio message is configured to be processed by a local administrator program on the smart radio that includes administrative privileges that enable reducing the volume setting.

12. The method of claim **9**, wherein the audio message is configured to be acted upon by a hardware circuit of the smart radio that causes a reduction to the volume setting.

13. The method of claim **9**, wherein the audio message is configured to be received by the streaming audio application and the authenticating of the smart radio enables the administrative platform with control over the streaming audio application and causes a reduction to the volume setting.

14. The method of claim **9**, further comprising:
transmitting an audio safety notice toward the smart radio;
and

remotely causing the smart radio to play the audio safety notice at a volume higher than the reduces the volume setting of the streaming audio application.

15. A system that remotely regulates audio output of a radio device, comprising:

a smart radio that is authenticated with an administrative platform that is separate from the smart radio, wherein the smart radio includes:

a speaker;
a wireless transceiver;
a streaming audio application; and
a volume setting associated with the streaming audio application; and

the administrative platform communicatively coupled to the smart radio via the wireless transceiver and configured to identify a safety event associated with a user

of the smart radio and in response to said identification of the safety event, transmit a remote signal toward the smart radio, the remote signal configured to cause the smart radio to reduce the volume setting of the streaming audio application.

16. The system of claim **15**, wherein the smart radio further includes an operating system that processes the remote signal, wherein in response to the remote signal the operating system employs root access to the smart radio and wherein the operating system reduces the volume setting.

17. The system of claim **15**, wherein the smart radio further includes a local administrator program that includes administrative privileges and processes the remote signal, wherein in response to the remote signal the local administrator program enables reducing the volume setting.

18. The system of claim **15**, wherein the remote signal is configured to be acted upon by a hardware circuit of the smart radio that causes a reduction to the volume setting.

19. The system of claim **15**, wherein the remote signal is configured to be received by the streaming audio application and the authenticating of the smart radio enables the administrative platform with control over the streaming audio application and causes a reduction to the volume setting.

20. The system of claim **15**, wherein the wireless transceiver of the smart radio is further configured with two-way communications with a plurality of other smart radio devices that are each authenticated with the administrative platform; and

The smart radio includes instructions that when executed cause the smart radio to:

receive, by the smart radio, an audio message via the two-way communications associated with the user of the smart radio; and

in response to said receiving of the audio message, automatically reduce the volume setting of the streaming audio application while the audio message plays simultaneously through the speaker of the smart radio.

21. The system of claim **15**, wherein the remote signal that is configured to cause the smart radio to reduce the volume setting of the streaming audio application further modifies an audio input channel away from the streaming audio application to a safety channel.

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